

Environment & Ecology — UPSC Prelims PYQ

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— 2026 —

UPSC 2026

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q22. With reference to Madhav National Park, which of the following statements is/are correct ?

1. It was declared a Tiger Reserve in India in 2025.
2. Sakhya Sagar, which is designated as a Ramsar Site, is situated within this National Park.
3. Its area is shared between Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan.

Select the answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2**
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2026

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

difficult

Q26. Consider the following statements about *Rhynchostylis retusa* (Foxtail orchid) :

1. It is an epiphytic orchid.
2. The species is endemic to North-east India.
3. It is the State flower of Arunachal Pradesh and Assam.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 3**
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2026

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

difficult

Q28. At the United Nations Ocean Conference (UNOC) held in June, 2025 in France, the Food and Agricultural Organization (FAO) of the United Nations demonstrated its leading voice on marine and ocean issues, especially on sustainable fisheries and aquaculture for resilient livelihood and “Blue Transformation”.

Which of the following combinations about the “Four Betters” proposed by FAO for “Blue Transformation” is correct ?

- (a) Better production, better nutrition, better environment and better ocean
- (b) Better production, better nutrition, better environment and better life**
- (c) Better coral reefs, better nutrition, better environment and better life
- (d) Better estuaries, better nutrition, better environment and better mangrove vegetation

Answer: (b)

Q30. Which one of the following is the first Plan Vivo certified Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation (REDD+) project in India ?

- (a) Uttarakhand REDD+ project
- (b) ICFRE-ICIMOD Transboundary REDD+ project in North-Eastern Himalayas
- (c) Khasi Hills Community REDD+ project**
- (d) Sikkim Mamley Kamrang Community REDD+ project

Answer: (c)

Q31. Consider the following statements with reference to India's response to climate change :
I. India's Long-Term Low Emission Development Strategy (LT-LEDS) is a crucial tool for achieving net-zero emissions by 2070.

II. India's 4th Biennial Update Report (BUR-4) submitted in December, 2024 recorded around 8% decrease in Greenhouse gas emissions in 2020 over 2019.

III. Climate-resilient development necessarily depends on quick and short-term achievement of emission reduction targets.

Which of the following relationships among the above statements is/are correct ?

- 1. Statement I is empirically supported by statement II.**
- 2. Statement III contradicts the approach implicit in statement I.**
- 3. Statement I and statement III together establish the premise of long-term sustainability.**

Select the answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2**
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

Q32. With respect to the Western Hoolock Gibbons, which of the following statements is/are correct ?

1. A Sanctuary in North-east India is home to this ape species listed as Endangered in the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List.

2. They have specialized brachiation and can easily swing between trees.

3. They possess a strong and heavy build like gorillas, yet are remarkably agile tree climbers.

Select the answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2**
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

Q33. Which of the following best explain(s) the rationale for protecting mangrove ecosystems in the context of climate resilience ?

1. Mangroves reduce tidal energy and store freshwater, making them ideal sites for paddy cultivation in saline estuarine belts.
2. Their salt-sensitive roots filter seawater, making mangroves key to converting coastal land into freshwater aquaculture zones.
3. By withstanding tidal surges and offering biomass resources, mangroves function both as natural bio-shields and livelihood bases for rural communities.

Select the answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only**

Answer: (d)

Q37. Which of the following statements with regard to the arrival of Amur Falcons at Doyang Lake in Nagaland each year from Mongolia is/are correct ?

1. It showcases how sustained local conservation efforts can contribute to the arrival and protection of international migratory birds.
2. It reflects the global success of advanced tracking technologies that guide migratory birds back to their stopover sites.
3. It confirms that Amur Falcons have adapted to permanent residency in India due to favourable habitat changes.

Select the answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 1 and 2
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (a)

Q42. Which of the following statements in relation to NIRANTAR (National Institute for Research and Application of Natural Resources to Transform, Adapt and Build Resilience), a platform of institutions under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, is/are correct ?

1. Ecosystem Survey and Analysis is a vertical under this platform, the lead institute of which is Botanical Survey of India, Kolkata.
2. Research and Management of Ecosystem Service is a vertical under this platform, the lead institute of which is Central Zoo Authority, New Delhi.
3. Capacity Development Support is a vertical under this platform, the lead institute of which is Indian Institute of Forest Management, Bhopal.

Select the answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 1 and 3 only**
- (c) 2 only
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2025

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

easy

Q9. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

Circular economy reduces the emissions of greenhouse gases.

Statement II :

Circular economy reduces the use of raw materials as inputs.

Statement III :

Circular economy reduces wastage in the production process.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I**
- (b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
- (c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
- (d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2025

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

easy

Q29. Consider the following statements :

I. Without the atmosphere, temperature would be well below freezing point everywhere on the Earth's surface.

II. Heat absorbed and trapped by the atmosphere maintains our planet's average temperature.

III. Atmosphere's gases, like carbon dioxide, are particularly good at absorbing and trapping radiation.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and III only
- (b) I and II only
- (c) I, II and III**
- (d) II and III only

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2025

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q31. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

Studies indicate that carbon dioxide emissions from cement industry account for more than 5% of global carbon emissions.

Statement II :

Silica-bearing clay is mixed with limestone while manufacturing cement.

Statement III :

Limestone is converted into lime during clinker production for cement manufacturing.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I
- (b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I**
- (c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
- (d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

Answer: (b)

Q32. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

At the 28th United Nations Climate Change Conference (COP28), India refrained from signing the 'Declaration on Climate and Health'.

Statement II :

The COP28 Declaration on Climate and Health is a binding declaration; and if signed, it becomes mandatory to decarbonize health sector.

Statement III :

If India's health sector is decarbonized, the resilience of its health-care system may be compromised.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I
- (b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
- (c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I**
- (d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

Answer: (c)

Q34. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

Article 6 of the Paris Agreement on climate change is frequently discussed in global discussions on sustainable development and climate change.

Statement II :

Article 6 of the Paris Agreement on climate change sets out the principles of carbon markets.

Statement III :

Article 6 of the Paris Agreement on climate change intends to promote inter-country non-market strategies to reach their climate targets.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I**
- (b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
- (c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
- (d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

Answer: (a)

Q38. Consider the following statements :

I. Carbon dioxide (CO₂) emissions in India are less than 0.5 t CO₂/capita.

II. In terms of CO₂ emissions from fuel combustion, India ranks second in Asia-Pacific region.

III. Electricity and heat producers are the largest sources of CO₂ emissions in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I and III only
- (b) II only
- (c) II and III only**
- (d) I, II and III

Answer: (c)

Q40. With reference to the planet Earth, consider the following statements :

I. Rain forests produce more oxygen than that produced by oceans.

II. Marine phytoplankton and photosynthetic bacteria produce about 50% of world's oxygen.

III. Well-oxygenated surface water contains several folds higher oxygen than that in atmospheric air.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I and II
- (b) II only**
- (c) I and III
- (d) None of the above statements is correct

Answer: (b)

Q50. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

Activated carbon is a good and an attractive tool to remove pollutants from effluent streams and to remediate contaminants from various industries.

Statement II :

Activated carbon exhibits a large surface area and a strong potential for adsorbing heavy metals.

Statement III :

Activated carbon can be easily synthesized from environmental wastes with high carbon content.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I**
- (b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
- (c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
- (d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

Answer: (a)

Q63. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

Of the two major ethanol producers in the world, i.e., Brazil and the United States of America, the former produces more ethanol than the latter.

Statement II :

Unlike in the United States of America where corn is the principal feedstock for ethanol production, sugarcane is the principal feedstock for ethanol production in Brazil.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
- (b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
- (c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
- (d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2025

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q90. Which organization has enacted the Nature Restoration Law (NRL) to tackle climate change and biodiversity loss?

- (a) The European Union**
- (b) The World Bank
- (c) The Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development
- (d) The Food and Agriculture Organization

Answer: (a)

— 2024 —

UPSC 2024

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q16. One of the following regions has the world's largest tropical peatland, which holds about three years worth of global carbon emissions from fossil fuels; and the possible destruction of which can exert detrimental effect on the global climate. Which one of the following denotes that region ?

- (a) Amazon Basin
- (b) Congo Basin**
- (c) Kikori Basin
- (d) Rio de la Plata Basin

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2024

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

easy

Q17. With reference to perfluoroalkyl and polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS) that are used in making many consumer products, consider the following statements :

1. PFAS are found to be widespread in drinking water, food and food packaging materials.
2. PFAS are not easily degraded in the environment.
3. Persistent exposure to PFAS can lead to bioaccumulation in animal bodies.

Which of the statements given above are correct ?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q18. Consider the following :

1. Carabid beetles
2. Centipedes
3. Flies
4. Termites
5. Wasps

Parasitoid species are found in how many of the above kind of organisms ?

- (a) Only two
- (b) Only three**
- (c) Only four
- (d) All five

Answer: (b)

Q19. Consider the following plants :

1. Groundnut
2. Horse-gram
3. Soybean

How many of the above belong to the pea family ?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three**
- (d) None

Answer: (c)

Q20. Consider the following statements :

Statement-I :

The Indian Flying Fox is placed under the “vermin” category in the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972.

Statement-II :

The Indian Flying Fox feeds on the blood of other animals.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements ?

- (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
- (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
- (c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
- (d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

Answer: cancelled by UPSC — marks awarded to all candidates

Q21. The organisms "Cicada, Froghopper and Pond skater" are :

- (a) Birds
- (b) Fish
- (c) Insects**
- (d) Reptiles

Answer: (c)

Q22. Consider the following statements :

Statement-I :

Many chewing gums found in the market are considered a source of environmental pollution.

Statement-II :

Many chewing gums contain plastic as gum base.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements ?

- (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I**
- (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
- (c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
- (d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

Answer: (a)

Q23. Consider the following pairs :

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched ?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None**

Answer: (d)

Q25. Consider the following statements :

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Which of the statements given above are correct ?

- (a) 1 and 2 only**
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

Q28. Which one of the following shows a unique relationship with an insect that has coevolved with it and that is the only insect that can pollinate this tree ?

- (a) Fig**
- (b) Mahua
- (c) Sandalwood
- (d) Silk cotton

Answer: (a)

Q29. Consider the following :

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

How many of the above have poisonous species among them ?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three**
- (d) None

Answer: (c)

Q30. Consider the following :

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

How many of the above trees are actually native to India ?

- (a) Only one**
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

Answer: (a)

Q90. According to the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), which one of the following is the largest source of sulphur dioxide emissions ?

- (a) Locomotives using fossil fuels
- (b) Ships using fossil fuels
- (c) Extraction of metals from ores
- (d) Power plants using fossil fuels**

Answer: (d)

Q96. Consider the following statements :

Statement-I :

The European Parliament approved The Net-Zero Industry Act recently.

Statement-II :

The European Union intends to achieve carbon neutrality by 2040 and therefore aims to develop all of its own clean technology by that time.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements ?

- (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
- (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
- (c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect**
- (d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

Answer: (c)

Q10. With reference to India's projects on connectivity, consider the following statements :

- 1. East-West Corridor under Golden Quadrilateral Project connects Dibrugarh and Surat.**
- 2. Trilateral Highway connects Moreh in Manipur and Chiang Mai in Thailand via Myanmar.**
- 3. Bangladesh-China-India-Myanmar Economic Corridor connects Varanasi in Uttar Pradesh with Kunming in China.**

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None**

Answer: (d)

Q18. Consider the following statements :

- 1. Some microorganisms can grow in environments with temperature above the boiling point of water.**
- 2. Some microorganisms can grow in environments with temperature below the freezing point of water.**
- 3. Some microorganisms can grow in highly acidic environment with a pH below 3.**

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three**
- (d) None

Answer: (c)

Q19. Which one of the following makes a tool with a stick to scrape insects from a hole in a tree or a log of wood?

- (a) Fishing cat
- (b) Orangutan**
- (c) Otter
- (d) Sloth bear

Answer: (b)

Q20. Consider the following :

1. Aerosols
2. Foam agents
3. Fire retardants
4. Lubricants

In the making of how many of the above are hydrofluorocarbons used?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) Only three**
- (d) All four

Answer: (c)

Q23. Consider the following statements :

Statement-I :

Carbon markets are likely to be one of the most widespread tools in the fight against climate change.

Statement-II :

Carbon markets transfer resources from the private sector to the State.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I
- (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I**
- (c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
- (d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

Answer: (b)

Q38. Consider the following statements :

Once the Central Government notifies an area as a 'Community Reserve'

1. the Chief Wildlife Warden of the State becomes the governing authority of such forest
2. hunting is not allowed in such area
3. people of such area are allowed to collect non-timber forest produce
4. people of such area are allowed traditional agricultural practices

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two**
- (c) Only three
- (d) All four

Answer: (b)

Q59. Consider the following statements regarding mercury pollution :

1. Gold mining activity is a source of mercury pollution in the world.
2. Coal-based thermal power plants cause mercury pollution.
3. There is no known safe level of exposure to mercury.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two**
- (c) All three
- (d) None

Answer: (b)

Q66. With reference to coal-based thermal power plants in India, consider the following statements :

1. None of them uses seawater.
2. None of them is set up in water-stressed district.
3. None of them is privately owned.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None**

Answer: (d)

Q68. Consider the following activities :

1. Spreading finely ground basalt rock on farmlands extensively
2. Increasing the alkalinity of oceans by adding lime
3. Capturing carbon dioxide released by various industries and pumping it into abandoned subterranean mines in the form of carbonated waters

How many of the above activities are often considered and discussed for carbon capture and sequestration?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three**
- (d) None

Answer: (c)

Q76. Consider the following statements :

Statement-I :

According to the United Nations' 'World Water Development Report, 2022', India extracts more than a quarter of the world's groundwater withdrawal each year.

Statement-II :

India needs to extract more than a quarter of the world's groundwater each year to satisfy the drinking water and sanitation needs of almost 18% of world's population living in its territory.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I
- (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I
- (c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect**
- (d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

Answer: (c)

Q79. Consider the following statements :

1. In India, the Biodiversity Management Committees are key to the realization of the objectives of the Nagoya Protocol.

2. The Biodiversity Management Committees have important functions in determining access and benefit sharing, including the power to levy collection fees on the access of biological resources within its jurisdiction.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2**
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

Q99. Consider the following heavy industries :

- 1. Fertilizer plants**
- 2. Oil refineries**
- 3. Steel plants**

Green hydrogen is expected to play a significant role in decarbonizing how many of the above industries?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three**
- (d) None

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2022

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

easy

Q21. Among the following crops, which one is the most important anthropogenic source of both methane and nitrous oxide ?

- (a) Cotton
- (b) Rice**
- (c) Sugarcane
- (d) Wheat

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2022

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

moderate

Q22. "System of Rice Intensification" of cultivation, in which alternate wetting and drying of rice fields is practised, results in :

1. Reduced seed requirement
2. Reduced methane production
3. Reduced electricity consumption

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2022

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q42. Consider the following statements :

1. "The Climate Group" is an international non-profit organization that drives climate action by building large networks and runs them.
2. The International Energy Agency in partnership with the Climate Group launched a global initiative "EP100".
3. EP100 brings together leading companies committed to driving innovation in energy efficiency and increasing competitiveness while delivering on emission reduction goals.
4. Some Indian companies are members of EP100.
5. The International Energy Agency is the Secretariat to the "Under2 Coalition".

Which of the statements given above are correct ?

- (a) 1, 2, 4 and 5
- (b) 1, 3 and 4 only**
- (c) 2, 3 and 5 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Answer: (b)

Q43. "If rainforests and tropical forests are the lungs of the Earth, then surely wetlands function as its kidneys." Which one of the following functions of wetlands best reflects the above statement ?

- (a) The water cycle in wetlands involves surface runoff, subsoil percolation and evaporation.
- (b) Algae form the nutrient base upon which fish, crustaceans, molluscs, birds, reptiles and mammals thrive.
- (c) Wetlands play a vital role in maintaining sedimentation balance and soil stabilization.
- (d) Aquatic plants absorb heavy metals and excess nutrients.**

Answer: (d)

Q44. In the context of WHO Air Quality Guidelines, consider the following statements :

1. The 24-hour mean of PM_{2.5} should not exceed 15 µg/m³ and annual mean of PM_{2.5} should not exceed 5 µg/m³.
2. In a year, the highest levels of ozone pollution occur during the periods of inclement weather.
3. PM₁₀ can penetrate the lung barrier and enter the bloodstream.
4. Excessive ozone in the air can trigger asthma.

Which of the statements given above are correct ?

- (a) 1, 3 and 4
- (b) 1 and 4 only**
- (c) 2, 3 and 4
- (d) 1 and 2 only

Answer: (b)

Q45. With reference to "Gucchi" sometimes mentioned in the news, consider the following statements :

1. It is a fungus.
2. It grows in some Himalayan forest areas.
3. It is commercially cultivated in the Himalayan foothills of north-eastern India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 2**
- (d) 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q47. Which of the following is not a bird ?

- (a) Golden Mahseer**
- (b) Indian Nightjar
- (c) Spoonbill
- (d) White Ibis

Answer: (a)

Q48. Which of the following are nitrogen-fixing plants ?

- 1. Alfalfa**
- 2. Amaranth**
- 3. Chickpea**
- 4. Clover**
- 5. Purslane (Kulfa)**
- 6. Spinach**

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1, 3 and 4 only**
- (b) 1, 3, 5 and 6 only
- (c) 2, 4, 5 and 6 only
- (d) 1, 2, 4, 5 and 6

Answer: (a)

Q49. "Biorock technology" is talked about in which one of the following situations ?

- (a) Restoration of damaged coral reefs**
- (b) Development of building materials using plant residues
- (c) Identification of areas for exploration/extraction of shale gas
- (d) Providing salt licks for wild animals in forests/protected areas

Answer: (a)

Q50. The "Miyawaki method" is well known for the :

- (a) Promotion of commercial farming in arid and semi-arid areas
- (b) Development of gardens using genetically modified flora
- (c) Creation of mini forests in urban areas**
- (d) Harvesting wind energy on coastal areas and on sea surfaces

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2022

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q75. Which one of the following has been constituted under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 ?

- (a) Central Water Commission
- (b) Central Ground Water Board
- (c) Central Ground Water Authority**
- (d) National Water Development Agency

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2022

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

easy

Q80. Which one of the following best describes the term "greenwashing" ?

- (a) Conveying a false impression that a company's products are eco-friendly and environmentally sound**
- (b) Non-inclusion of ecological/environmental costs in the Annual Financial Statements of a country
- (c) Ignoring the disastrous ecological consequences while undertaking infrastructure development
- (d) Making mandatory provisions for environmental costs in a government project/programme

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2022

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

moderate

Q84. Consider the following statements :

- 1. Gujarat has the largest solar park in India.**
 - 2. Kerala has a fully solar powered International Airport.**
 - 3. Goa has the largest floating solar photovoltaic project in India.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?**

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2022

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

difficult

Q89. With reference to Indian laws about wildlife protection, consider the following statements :

- 1. Wild animals are the sole property of the government.**
- 2. When a wild animal is declared protected, such animal is entitled for equal protection whether it is found in protected areas or outside.**
- 3. Apprehension of a protected wild animal becoming a danger to human life is sufficient ground for its capture or killing.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2022

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q90. Certain species of which one of the following organisms are well known as cultivators of fungi ?

- (a) Ant**
- (b) Cockroach
- (c) Crab
- (d) Spider

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2022

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

easy

Q100. Consider the following :

- 1. Carbon monoxide**
- 2. Nitrogen oxide**
- 3. Ozone**
- 4. Sulphur dioxide**

Excess of which of the above in the environment is/are cause(s) of acid rain ?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 2 and 4 only**
- (c) 4 only
- (d) 1, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

— 2021 —

UPSC 2021

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

moderate

Q16. 'R2 Code of Practices' constitutes a tool available for promoting the adoption of

- (a) environmentally responsible practices in electronics recycling industry**
- (b) ecological management of 'Wetlands of International Importance' under the Ramsar Convention
- (c) sustainable practices in the cultivation of agricultural crops in degraded lands
- (d) 'Environmental Impact Assessment' in the exploitation of natural resources

Answer: (a)

Q17. Why is there a concern about copper smelting plants?

1. They may release lethal quantities of carbon monoxide into environment.
2. The copper slag can cause the leaching of some heavy metals into environment.
3. They may release sulphur dioxide as a pollutant.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q18. With reference to furnace oil, consider the following statements :

1. It is a product of oil refineries.
2. Some industries use it to generate power.
3. Its use causes sulphur emissions into environment.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q19. What is blue carbon?

- (a) Carbon captured by oceans and coastal ecosystems**
- (b) Carbon sequestered in forest biomass and agricultural soils
- (c) Carbon contained in petroleum and natural gas
- (d) Carbon present in atmosphere

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2021

Environment & Ecology > Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q20. In the nature, which of the following is/are most likely to be found surviving on a surface without soil?

1. Fern
2. Lichen
3. Moss
4. Mushroom

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 4 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3**
- (d) 1, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2021

Environment & Ecology > Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

easy

Q21. Which one of the following is used in preparing a natural mosquito repellent?

- (a) Congress grass
- (b) Elephant grass
- (c) Lemongrass**
- (d) Nut grass

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2021

Environment & Ecology > Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q22. Consider the following kinds of organisms :

1. Copepods
2. Cyanobacteria
3. Diatoms
4. Foraminifera

Which of the above are primary producers in the food chains of oceans?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3**
- (c) 3 and 4
- (d) 1 and 4

Answer: (b)

Q23. Consider the following animals :

- 1. Hedgehog**
- 2. Marmot**
- 3. Pangolin**

To reduce the chance of being captured by predators, which of the above organisms rolls up/roll up and protects/protect its/their vulnerable parts?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q24. With reference to the 'New York Declaration on Forests', which of the following statements are correct?

- 1. It was first endorsed at the United Nations Climate Summit in 2014.**
- 2. It endorses a global timeline to end the loss of forests.**
- 3. It is a legally binding international declaration.**
- 4. It is endorsed by governments, big companies and indigenous communities.**
- 5. India was one of the signatories at its inception.**

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 4**
- (b) 1, 3 and 5
- (c) 3 and 4
- (d) 2 and 5

Answer: (a)

Q25. Magnetite particles, suspected to cause neurodegenerative problems, are generated as environmental pollutants from which of the following?

- 1. Brakes of motor vehicles**
- 2. Engines of motor vehicles**
- 3. Microwave stoves within homes**
- 4. Power plants**
- 5. Telephone lines**

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 5 only
- (b) 1, 2 and 4 only**
- (c) 3, 4 and 5 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2021

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q26. Which one of the following is a filter feeder?

- (a) Catfish
- (b) Octopus
- (c) Oyster**
- (d) Pelican

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2021

Environment & Ecology › Biogeochemical Cycles & Earth Systems

easy

Q27. In case of which one of the following biogeochemical cycles, the weathering of rocks is the main source of release of nutrient to enter the cycle?

- (a) Carbon cycle
- (b) Nitrogen cycle
- (c) Phosphorus cycle**
- (d) Sulphur cycle

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2021

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q28. Which of the following are detritivores?

1. Earthworms
2. Jellyfish
3. Millipedes
4. Seahorses
5. Woodlice

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 only
- (b) 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 5 only**
- (d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2021

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q29. The 'Common Carbon Metric', supported by UNEP, has been developed for

- (a) assessing the carbon footprint of building operations around the world**
- (b) enabling commercial farming entities around the world to enter carbon emission trading
- (c) enabling governments to assess the overall carbon footprint caused by their countries
- (d) assessing the overall carbon footprint caused by the use of fossil fuels by the world in a unit time

Answer: (a)

Q51. How is permaculture farming different from conventional chemical farming?

1. Permaculture farming discourages monocultural practices but in conventional chemical farming, monoculture practices are predominant.
2. Conventional chemical farming can cause increase in soil salinity but the occurrence of such phenomenon is not observed in permaculture farming.
3. Conventional chemical farming is easily possible in semi-arid regions but permaculture farming is not so easily possible in such regions.
4. Practice of mulching is very important in permaculture farming but not necessarily so in conventional chemical farming.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 3
- (b) 1, 2 and 4**
- (c) 4 only
- (d) 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q52. With reference to 'palm oil', consider the following statements :

1. The palm oil tree is native to Southeast Asia.
2. The palm oil is a raw material for some industries producing lipstick and perfumes.
3. The palm oil can be used to produce biodiesel.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q56. Consider the following statements :

1. The Global Ocean Commission grants licences for seabed exploration and mining in international waters.
2. India has received licences for seabed mineral exploration in international waters.
3. 'Rare earth minerals' are present on seafloor in international waters.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q59. In the context of India's preparation for Climate-Smart Agriculture, consider the following statements :

1. The 'Climate-Smart Village' approach in India is a part of a project led by the Climate Change, Agriculture and Food Security (CCAFS), an international research programme.
2. The project of CCAFS is carried out under Consultative Group on International Agricultural Research (CGIAR) headquartered in France.
3. The International Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics (ICRISAT) in India is one of the CGIAR's research centres.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q60. "Leaf litter decomposes faster than in any other biome and as a result the soil surface is often almost bare. Apart from trees, the vegetation is largely composed of plant forms that reach up into the canopy vicariously, by climbing the trees or growing as epiphytes, rooted on the upper branches of trees." This is the most likely description of

- (a) coniferous forest
- (b) dry deciduous forest
- (c) mangrove forest
- (d) tropical rain forest**

Answer: (d)

Q61. The vegetation of savannah consists of grassland with scattered small trees, but extensive areas have no trees. The forest development in such areas is generally kept in check by one or more or a combination of some conditions. Which of the following are such conditions?

1. Burrowing animals and termites
2. Fire
3. Grazing herbivores
4. Seasonal rainfall
5. Soil properties

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 4 and 5
- (c) 2, 3 and 4**
- (d) 1, 3 and 5

Answer: (c)

Q63. Consider the following statements :

1. Moringa (drumstick tree) is a leguminous evergreen tree.
2. Tamarind tree is endemic to South Asia.
3. In India, most of the tamarind is collected as minor forest produce.
4. India exports tamarind and seeds of moringa.
5. Seeds of moringa and tamarind can be used in the production of biofuels.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2, 4 and 5
- (b) 3, 4 and 5**
- (c) 1, 3 and 4
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 5

Answer: (b)

Q74. Bisphenol A (BPA), a cause of concern, is a structural/key component in the manufacture of which of the following kinds of plastics?

- (a) Low-density polyethylene
- (b) Polycarbonate**
- (c) Polyethylene terephthalate
- (d) Polyvinyl chloride

Answer: (b)

Q84. At the national level, which ministry is the nodal agency to ensure effective implementation of the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006?

- (a) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- (b) Ministry of Panchayati Raj
- (c) Ministry of Rural Development
- (d) Ministry of Tribal Affairs**

Answer: (d)

Q97. Consider the following statements :

Statement 1 :

The United Nations Capital Development Fund (UNCDF) and the Arbor Day Foundation have recently recognized Hyderabad as 2020 Tree City of the World.

Statement 2 :

Hyderabad was selected for the recognition for a year following its commitment to grow and maintain the urban forests.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement 1 and Statement 2 are correct and Statement 2 is the correct explanation for Statement 1
- (b) Both Statement 1 and Statement 2 are correct but Statement 2 is not the correct explanation for Statement 1
- (c) Statement 1 is correct but Statement 2 is not correct
- (d) Statement 1 is not correct but Statement 2 is correct**

Answer: (d)

— 2020 —

Q72. With reference to Indian elephants, consider the following statements :

- 1. The leader of an elephant group is a female.**
 - 2. The maximum gestation period can be 22 months.**
 - 3. An elephant can normally go on calving till the age of 40 years only.**
 - 4. Among the States in India, the highest elephant population is in Kerala.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?**

- (a) 1 and 2 only**
- (b) 2 and 4 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 3 and 4 only

Answer: (a)

Q73. Which of the following Protected Areas are located in Cauvery basin ?

- 1. Nagarhole National Park**
- 2. Papikonda National Park**
- 3. Sathyamangalam Tiger Reserve**
- 4. Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary**

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 and 4 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only**
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2020

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q74. With reference to India's biodiversity, Ceylon frogmouth, Coppersmith barbet, Gray-chinned minivet and White-throated redstart are

- (a) Birds**
- (b) Primates
- (c) Reptiles
- (d) Amphibians

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2020

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q75. Which one of the following protected areas is well-known for the conservation of a sub-species of the Indian swamp deer (Barasingha) that thrives well on hard ground and is exclusively graminivorous ?

- (a) Kanha National Park**
- (b) Manas National Park
- (c) Mudumalai Wildlife Sanctuary
- (d) Tal Chhapar Wildlife Sanctuary

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2020

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

moderate

Q76. Steel slag can be the material for which of the following ?

- 1. Construction of base road**
- 2. Improvement of agricultural soil**
- 3. Production of cement**

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q77. Which of the following are the most likely places to find the musk deer in its natural habitat ?

1. Askot Wildlife Sanctuary
2. Gangotri National Park
3. Kishanpur Wildlife Sanctuary
4. Manas National Park

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1 and 4 only

Answer: (a)

Q78. In rural road construction, the use of which of the following is preferred for ensuring environmental sustainability or to reduce carbon footprint ?

1. Copper slag
2. Cold mix asphalt technology
3. Geotextiles
4. Hot mix asphalt technology
5. Portland cement

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 4 and 5 only
- (d) 1 and 5 only

Answer: (a)

Q79. Consider the following statements :

1. Coal ash contains arsenic, lead and mercury.
2. Coal-fired power plants release sulphur dioxide and oxides of nitrogen into the environment.
3. High ash content is observed in Indian coal.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

Q80. What is the use of biochar in farming ?

1. Biochar can be used as a part of the growing medium in vertical farming.
2. When biochar is a part of the growing medium, it promotes the growth of nitrogen-fixing microorganisms.
3. When biochar is a part of the growing medium, it enables the growing medium to retain water for longer time.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q81. If a particular plant species is placed under Schedule VI of The Wildlife Protection Act, 1972, what is the implication ?

- (a) A licence is required to cultivate that plant.**
- (b) Such a plant cannot be cultivated under any circumstances.
- (c) It is a Genetically Modified crop plant.
- (d) Such a plant is invasive and harmful to the ecosystem.

Answer: (a)

Q83. What is/are the advantage/advantages of zero tillage in agriculture ?

1. Sowing of wheat is possible without burning the residue of previous crop.
2. Without the need for nursery of rice saplings, direct planting of paddy seeds in the wet soil is possible.
3. Carbon sequestration in the soil is possible.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q84. According to India's National Policy on Biofuels, which of the following can be used as raw materials for the production of biofuels ?

1. Cassava
2. Damaged wheat grains
3. Groundnut seeds
4. Horse gram
5. Rotten potatoes
6. Sugar beet

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1, 2, 5 and 6 only
(b) 1, 3, 4 and 6 only
(c) 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
(d) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6

Answer: (a)

Q85. Which one of the following statements best describes the term 'Social Cost of Carbon' ? It is a measure, in monetary value, of the

- (a) long-term damage done by a tonne of CO₂ emissions in a given year.
(b) requirement of fossil fuels for a country to provide goods and services to its citizens, based on the burning of those fuels.
(c) efforts put in by a climate refugee to adapt to live in a new place.
(d) contribution of an individual person to the carbon footprint on the planet Earth.

Answer: (a)

Q90. In the context of India, which of the following is/are considered to be practice(s) of eco-friendly agriculture ?

1. Crop diversification
2. Legume intensification
3. Tensiometer use
4. Vertical farming

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) 3 only
(c) 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a)

Q91. What are the advantages of fertigation in agriculture ?

1. Controlling the alkalinity of irrigation water is possible.
2. Efficient application of Rock Phosphate and all other phosphatic fertilizers is possible.
3. Increased availability of nutrients to plants is possible.
4. Reduction in the leaching of chemical nutrients is possible.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only**
- (d) 2, 3 and 4 only

Answer: (c)

Q95. With reference to India's Desert National Park, which of the following statements are correct ?

1. It is spread over two districts.
2. There is no human habitation inside the Park.
3. It is one of the natural habitats of Great Indian Bustard.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q98. Consider the following statements :

1. 36% of India's districts are classified as "overexploited" or "critical" by the Central Ground Water Authority (CGWA).
2. CGWA was formed under the Environment (Protection) Act.
3. India has the largest area under groundwater irrigation in the world.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 2 only
- (d) 1 and 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2020

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q100. Among the following Tiger Reserves, which one has the largest area under "Critical Tiger Habitat" ?

- (a) Corbett
- (b) Ranthambore
- (c) Nagarjunsagar-Srisaillam**
- (d) Sunderbans

Answer: (c)

— 2019 —

UPSC 2019

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q18. Which one of the following National Parks lies completely in the temperate alpine zone?

- (a) Manas National Park
- (b) Namdapha National Park
- (c) Neora Valley National Park
- (d) Valley of Flowers National Park**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2019

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q22. Consider the following statements :

1. Asiatic lion is naturally found in India only.
2. Double-humped camel is naturally found in India only.
3. One-horned rhinoceros is naturally found in India only.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2019

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

easy

Q25. In the context of which of the following do some scientists suggest the use of cirrus cloud thinning technique and the injection of sulphate aerosol into stratosphere?

- (a) Creating the artificial rains in some regions
- (b) Reducing the frequency and intensity of tropical cyclones
- (c) Reducing the adverse effects of solar wind on the Earth
- (d) Reducing the global warming**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2019

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

easy

Q26. In the context of which one of the following are the terms 'pyrolysis and plasma gasification' mentioned?

- (a) Extraction of rare earth elements
- (b) Natural gas extraction technologies
- (c) Hydrogen fuel-based automobiles
- (d) Waste-to-energy technologies**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2019

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q27. Which of the following are in Agasthyamala Biosphere Reserve?

- (a) Neyyar, Peppara and Shendurney Wildlife Sanctuaries; and Kalakad Mundanthurai Tiger Reserve**
- (b) Mudumalai, Sathyamangalam and Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuaries; and Silent Valley National Park
- (c) Kaundinya, Gundla Brahmeswaram and Papikonda Wildlife Sanctuaries; and Mukurthi National Park
- (d) Kawal and Sri Venkateswara Wildlife Sanctuaries; and Nagarjunasagar-Srisailem Tiger Reserve

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2019

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q28. Consider the following statements :

- 1. Some species of turtles are herbivores.**
- 2. Some species of fish are herbivores.**
- 3. Some species of marine mammals are herbivores.**
- 4. Some species of snakes are viviparous.**

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 2 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Answer: (d)

Q29. Consider the following pairs :

Wildlife Naturally found in

- 1. Blue-finned Mahseer : Cauvery River**
- 2. Irrawaddy Dolphin : Chambal River**
- 3. Rusty-spotted Cat : Eastern Ghats**

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q30. Why is there a great concern about the 'microbeads' that are released into environment?

- (a) They are considered harmful to marine ecosystems.**
- (b) They are considered to cause skin cancer in children.
- (c) They are small enough to be absorbed by crop plants in irrigated fields.
- (d) They are often found to be used as food adulterants.

Answer: (a)

Q31. Recently, there was a growing awareness in our country about the importance of Himalayan nettle (*Girardinia diversifolia*) because it is found to be a sustainable source of

- (a) anti-malarial drug
- (b) biodiesel
- (c) pulp for paper industry
- (d) textile fibre**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2019

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q34. Which of the following statements are correct about the deposits of 'methane hydrate'?

1. Global warming might trigger the release of methane gas from these deposits.
2. Large deposits of 'methane hydrate' are found in Arctic Tundra and under the seafloor.
3. Methane in atmosphere oxidizes to carbon dioxide after a decade or two.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2019

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

moderate

Q35. Consider the following :

1. Carbon monoxide
2. Methane
3. Ozone
4. Sulphur dioxide

Which of the above are released into atmosphere due to the burning of crop/biomass residue?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 1 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2019

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q40. Consider the following statements :

1. Under Ramsar Convention, it is mandatory on the part of the Government of India to protect and conserve all the wetlands in the territory of India.
2. The Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2010 were framed by the Government of India based on the recommendations of Ramsar Convention.
3. The Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2010 also encompass the drainage area or catchment regions of the wetlands as determined by the authority.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q41. Consider the following statements :

- 1. Agricultural soils release nitrogen oxides into environment.**
 - 2. Cattle release ammonia into environment.**
 - 3. Poultry industry releases reactive nitrogen compounds into environment.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 2 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q58. Consider the following statements :

The Environment Protection Act, 1986 empowers the Government of India to

- 1. state the requirement of public participation in the process of environmental protection, and the procedure and manner in which it is sought**
- 2. lay down the standards for emission or discharge of environmental pollutants from various sources**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

Q59. As per the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016 in India, which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) Waste generator has to segregate waste into five categories.
- (b) The Rules are applicable to notified urban local bodies, notified towns and all industrial townships only.
- (c) The Rules provide for exact and elaborate criteria for the identification of sites for landfills and waste processing facilities.**
- (d) It is mandatory on the part of waste generator that the waste generated in one district cannot be moved to another district.

Answer: (c)

Q68. Consider the following statements :

- 1. As per law, the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority exists at both National and State levels.**
- 2. People's participation is mandatory in the compensatory afforestation programmes carried out under the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

Q78. In India, 'extended producer responsibility' was introduced as an important feature in which of the following?

- (a) The Bio-medical Waste (Management and Handling) Rules, 1998
- (b) The Recycled Plastic (Manufacturing and Usage) Rules, 1999
- (c) The e-Waste (Management and Handling) Rules, 2011**
- (d) The Food Safety and Standard Regulations, 2011

Answer: (c)

— 2018 —

Q2. Which of the following leaf modifications occur(s) in the desert areas to inhibit water loss ?

- 1. Hard and waxy leaves**
- 2. Tiny leaves**
- 3. Thorns instead of leaves**

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 2 and 3 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q4. How is the National Green Tribunal (NGT) different from the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) ?

1. The NGT has been established by an Act whereas the CPCB has been created by an executive order of the Government.
2. The NGT provides environmental justice and helps reduce the burden of litigation in the higher courts whereas the CPCB promotes cleanliness of streams and wells, and aims to improve the quality of air in the country.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

Q35. With reference to the 'Global Alliance for Climate-Smart Agriculture (GACSA)', which of the following statements is/are correct ?

1. GACSA is an outcome of the Climate Summit held in Paris in 2015.
2. Membership of GACSA does not create any binding obligations.
3. India was instrumental in the creation of GACSA.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q59. With reference to the circumstances in Indian agriculture, the concept of "Conservation Agriculture" assumes significance. Which of the following fall under the Conservation Agriculture ?

1. Avoiding the monoculture practices
2. Adopting minimum tillage
3. Avoiding the cultivation of plantation crops
4. Using crop residues to cover soil surface
5. Adopting spatial and temporal crop sequencing/crop rotations

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1, 3 and 4
- (b) 2, 3, 4 and 5
- (c) 2, 4 and 5**
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 5

Answer: (c)

Q60. The term "sixth mass extinction/sixth extinction" is often mentioned in the news in the context of the discussion of

- (a) Widespread monoculture practices in agriculture and large-scale commercial farming with indiscriminate use of chemicals in many parts of the world that may result in the loss of good native ecosystems.
- (b) Fears of a possible collision of a meteorite with the Earth in the near future in the manner it happened 65 million years ago that caused the mass extinction of many species including those of dinosaurs.
- (c) Large scale cultivation of genetically modified crops in many parts of the world and promoting their cultivation in other parts of the world which may cause the disappearance of good native crop plants and the loss of food biodiversity.
- (d) Mankind's over-exploitation/misuse of natural resources, fragmentation/loss of natural habitats, destruction of ecosystems, pollution and global climate change.**

Answer: (d)

Q65. Which of the following statements best describes "carbon fertilization" ?

- (a) Increased plant growth due to increased concentration of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere**
- (b) Increased temperature of Earth due to increased concentration of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere
- (c) Increased acidity of oceans as a result of increased concentration of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere
- (d) Adaptation of all living beings on Earth to the climate change brought about by the increased concentration of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere

Answer: (a)

Q81. Which of the following is/are the possible consequence/s of heavy sand mining in riverbeds ?

1. Decreased salinity in the river
2. Pollution of groundwater
3. Lowering of the water-table

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2018

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q83. The Partnership for Action on Green Economy (PAGE), a UN mechanism to assist countries transition towards greener and more inclusive economies, emerged at

- (a) The Earth Summit on Sustainable Development 2002, Johannesburg
- (b) The United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development 2012, Rio de Janeiro**
- (c) The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change 2015, Paris
- (d) The World Sustainable Development Summit 2016, New Delhi

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2018

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q86. Why is a plant called *Prosopis juliflora* often mentioned in news ?

- (a) Its extract is widely used in cosmetics.
- (b) It tends to reduce the biodiversity in the area in which it grows.**
- (c) Its extract is used in the synthesis of pesticides.
- (d) None of the above

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2018

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q87. Consider the following statements :

- 1. Most of the world's coral reefs are in tropical waters.**
 - 2. More than one-third of the world's coral reefs are located in the territories of Australia, Indonesia and Philippines.**
 - 3. Coral reefs host far more number of animal phyla than those hosted by tropical rainforests.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?**

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2018

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q88. "Momentum for Change : Climate Neutral Now" is an initiative launched by

- (a) The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
- (b) The UNEP Secretariat
- (c) The UNFCCC Secretariat**
- (d) The World Meteorological Organization

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2018

Environment & Ecology > Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q94. In which one of the following States is Pakhui Wildlife Sanctuary located ?

(a) Arunachal Pradesh

(b) Manipur

(c) Meghalaya

(d) Nagaland

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2018

Environment & Ecology > Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q98. Consider the following statements :

1. The definition of "Critical Wildlife Habitat" is incorporated in the Forest Rights Act, 2006.

2. For the first time in India, Baigas have been given Habitat Rights.

3. Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change officially decides and declares Habitat Rights for Primitive and Vulnerable Tribal Groups in any part of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2018

Environment & Ecology > Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

easy

Q99. Consider the following :

1. Birds

2. Dust blowing

3. Rain

4. Wind blowing

Which of the above spread plant diseases ?

(a) 1 and 3 only

(b) 3 and 4 only

(c) 1, 2 and 4 only

(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2018

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

moderate

Q100. With reference to organic farming in India, consider the following statements :

- 1. 'The National Programme for Organic Production' (NPOP) is operated under the guidelines and directions of the Union Ministry of Rural Development.**
 - 2. 'The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority' (APEDA) functions as the Secretariat for the implementation of NPOP.**
 - 3. Sikkim has become India's first fully organic State.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?**

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

— 2017 —

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q4. From the ecological point of view, which one of the following assumes importance in being a good link between the Eastern Ghats and the Western Ghats ?

- (a) Sathyamangalam Tiger Reserve**
- (b) Nallamala Forest
- (c) Nagarhole National Park
- (d) Seshachalam Biosphere Reserve

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

moderate

Q6. Consider the following statements in respect of Trade Related Analysis of Fauna and Flora in Commerce (TRAFFIC) :

- 1. TRAFFIC is a bureau under United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP).**
- 2. The mission of TRAFFIC is to ensure that trade in wild plants and animals is not a threat to the conservation of nature.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q10. Which of the following statements is/are correct regarding Smart India Hackathon 2017 ?

1. It is a centrally sponsored scheme for developing every city of our country into Smart Cities in a decade.
2. It is an initiative to identify new digital technology innovations for solving the many problems faced by our country.
3. It is a programme aimed at making all the financial transactions in our country completely digital in a decade.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 2 and 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q12. With reference to Manipuri Sankirtana, consider the following statements :

1. It is a song and dance performance.
2. Cymbals are the only musical instruments used in the performance.
3. It is performed to narrate the life and deeds of Lord Krishna.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 1 and 3 only**
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q21. Due to some reasons, if there is a huge fall in the population of species of butterflies, what could be its likely consequence/consequences ?

1. Pollination of some plants could be adversely affected.
2. There could be a drastic increase in the fungal infections of some cultivated plants.
3. It could lead to a fall in the population of some species of wasps, spiders and birds.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology > Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q25. In the context of mitigating the impending global warming due to anthropogenic emissions of carbon dioxide, which of the following can be the potential sites for carbon sequestration ?

1. Abandoned and uneconomic coal seams
2. Depleted oil and gas reservoirs
3. Subterranean deep saline formations

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology > Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q35. According to the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, which of the following animals cannot be hunted by any person except under some provisions provided by law ?

1. Gharial
2. Indian wild ass
3. Wild buffalo

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology > International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q52. With reference to 'Global Climate Change Alliance', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is an initiative of the European Union.
2. It provides technical and financial support to targeted developing countries to integrate climate change into their development policies and budgets.
3. It is coordinated by World Resources Institute (WRI) and World Business Council for Sustainable Development (WBCSD).

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only**
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q60. With reference to the role of UN-Habitat in the United Nations programme working towards a better urban future, which of the statements is/are correct ?

1. UN-Habitat has been mandated by the United Nations General Assembly to promote socially and environmentally sustainable towns and cities to provide adequate shelter for all.
2. Its partners are either governments or local urban authorities only.
3. UN-Habitat contributes to the overall objective of the United Nations system to reduce poverty and to promote access to safe drinking water and basic sanitation.

Select the correct answer using the code given below ;

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 1 and 3 only**
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q65. Consider the following statements :

1. Climate and Clean Air Coalition (CCAC) to Reduce Short Lived Climate Pollutants is a unique initiative of G20 group of countries.
2. The CCAC focuses on methane, black carbon and hydrofluorocarbons.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q67. If you want to see gharials in their natural habitat, which one of the following is the best place to visit ?

- (a) Bhitarkanika Mangroves
- (b) Chambal River**
- (c) Pulicat Lake
- (d) Deepor Beel

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

moderate

Q71. Which of the following practices can help in water conservation in agriculture ?

1. Reduced or zero tillage of the land
2. Applying gypsum before irrigating the field
3. Allowing crop residue to remain in the field

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q80. The term 'M-STrIPES' is sometimes seen in the news in the context of

- (a) Captive breeding of Wild Fauna
- (b) Maintenance of Tiger Reserves**
- (c) Indigenous Satellite Navigation System
- (d) Security of National Highways

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

easy

Q91. In India, if a species of tortoise is declared protected under Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, what does it imply ?

- (a) It enjoys the same level of protection as the tiger.**
- (b) It no longer exists in the wild, a few individuals are under captive protection; and now it is impossible to prevent its extinction.
- (c) It is endemic to a particular region of India.
- (d) Both (b) and (c) stated above are correct in this context.

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2017

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q95. Recently there was a proposal to translocate some of the lions from their natural habitat in Gujarat to which one of the following sites ?

- (a) Corbett National Park
- (b) Kuno Palpur Wildlife Sanctuary**
- (c) Mudumalai Wildlife Sanctuary
- (d) Sariska National Park

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q6. The term 'Intended Nationally Determined Contributions' is sometimes seen in the news in the context of

- (a) pledges made by the European countries to rehabilitate refugees from the war-affected Middle East
- (b) plan of action outlined by the countries of the world to combat climate change**
- (c) capital contributed by the member countries in the establishment of Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank
- (d) plan of action outlined by the countries of the world regarding Sustainable Development Goals

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q13. What is/are the importance/importances of the 'United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification'?

1. It aims to promote effective action through innovative national programmes and supportive international partnerships.
2. It has a special/particular focus on South Asia and North Africa regions, and its Secretariat facilitates the allocation of major portion of financial resources to these regions.
3. It is committed to bottom-up approach, encouraging the participation of local people in combating the desertification.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q22. In which of the following regions of India are you most likely to come across the 'Great Indian Hornbill' in its natural habitat?

- (a) Sand deserts of northwest India
- (b) Higher Himalayas of Jammu and Kashmir
- (c) Salt marshes of western Gujarat
- (d) Western Ghats**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Water & Wetland Conservation

moderate

Q23. Which of the following are the key features of 'National Ganga River Basin Authority (NGRBA)'?

1. River basin is the unit of planning and management.
2. It spearheads the river conservation efforts at the national level.
3. One of the Chief Ministers of the States through which the Ganga flows becomes the Chairman of NGRBA on rotation basis.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

moderate

Q27. The FAO accords the status of 'Globally Important Agricultural Heritage System (GIAHS)' to traditional agricultural systems. What is the overall goal of this initiative?

1. To provide modern technology, training in modern farming methods and financial support to local communities of identified GIAHS so as to greatly enhance their agricultural productivity
2. To identify and safeguard eco-friendly traditional farm practices and their associated landscapes, agricultural biodiversity and knowledge systems of the local communities
3. To provide Geographical Indication status to all the varieties of agricultural produce in such identified GIAHS

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q30. Consider the following pairs :

Terms sometimes seen in the news Their origin

1. Annex-I Countries : Cartagena Protocol
2. Certified Emissions Reductions : Nagoya Protocol
3. Clean Development Mechanism : Kyoto Protocol

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q33. Which of the following best describes/describe the aim of 'Green India Mission' of the Government of India?

- 1. Incorporating environmental benefits and costs into the Union and State Budgets thereby implementing the 'green accounting'**
- 2. Launching the second green revolution to enhance agricultural output so as to ensure food security to one and all in the future**
- 3. Restoring and enhancing forest cover and responding to climate change by a combination of adaptation and mitigation measures**

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

moderate

Q36. 'Net metering' is sometimes seen in the news in the context of promoting the

- (a) production and use of solar energy by the households/consumers**
- (b) use of piped natural gas in the kitchens of households
- (c) installation of CNG kits in motor-cars
- (d) installation of water meters in urban households

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

moderate

Q44. What is/are unique about 'Kharai camel', a breed found in India?

- 1. It is capable of swimming up to three kilometres in seawater.**
- 2. It survives by grazing on mangroves.**
- 3. It lives in the wild and cannot be domesticated.**

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only**
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

Q45. Recently, our scientists have discovered a new and distinct species of banana plant which attains a height of about 11 metres and has orange-coloured fruit pulp. In which part of India has it been discovered?

- (a) Andaman Islands**
- (b) Anaimalai Forests
- (c) Maikala Hills
- (d) Tropical rain forests of northeast

Answer: (a)

Q52. With reference to an initiative called 'The Economics of Ecosystems and Biodiversity (TEEB)', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is an initiative hosted by UNEP, IMF and World Economic Forum.
2. It is a global initiative that focuses on drawing attention to the economic benefits of biodiversity.
3. It presents an approach that can help decision-makers recognize, demonstrate and capture the value of ecosystems and biodiversity.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q53. With reference to 'Red Sanders', sometimes seen in the news, consider the following statements :

1. It is a tree species found in a part of South India.
 2. It is one of the most important trees in the tropical rain forest areas of South India.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

Q54. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

Proper design and effective implementation of UN-REDD+ Programme can significantly contribute to

- 1. protection of biodiversity**
- 2. resilience of forest ecosystems**
- 3. poverty reduction**

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q55. What is 'Greenhouse Gas Protocol'?

- (a) It is an international accounting tool for government and business leaders to understand, quantify and manage greenhouse gas emissions**
- (b) It is an initiative of the United Nations to offer financial incentives to developing countries to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and to adopt eco-friendly technologies
- (c) It is an inter-governmental agreement ratified by all the member countries of the United Nations to reduce greenhouse gas emissions to specified levels by the year 2022
- (d) It is one of the multilateral REDD+ initiatives hosted by the World Bank

Answer: (a)

Q57. With reference to 'Agenda 21', sometimes seen in the news, consider the following statements :

- 1. It is a global action plan for sustainable development.**
 - 2. It originated in the World Summit on Sustainable Development held in Johannesburg in 2002.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q68. 'Gadgil Committee Report' and 'Kasturirangan Committee Report', sometimes seen in the news, are related to

- (a) constitutional reforms
- (b) Ganga Action Plan
- (c) linking of rivers
- (d) protection of Western Ghats**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

moderate

Q78. On which of the following can you find the Bureau of Energy Efficiency Star Label?

- 1. Ceiling fans**
- 2. Electric geysers**
- 3. Tubular fluorescent lamps**

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q81. Consider the following statements :

- 1. The International Solar Alliance was launched at the United Nations Climate Change Conference in 2015.**
- 2. The Alliance includes all the member countries of the United Nations.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

moderate

Q86. In the cities of our country, which among the following atmospheric gases are normally considered in calculating the value of Air Quality Index?

1. Carbon dioxide
2. Carbon monoxide
3. Nitrogen dioxide
4. Sulfur dioxide
5. Methane

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 4 and 5 only
(d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q90. Recently, for the first time in our country, which of the following States has declared a particular butterfly as 'State Butterfly'?

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh
(b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Karnataka
(d) Maharashtra

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q97. With reference to the Agreement at the UNFCCC Meeting in Paris in 2015, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The Agreement was signed by all the member countries of the UN and it will go into effect in 2017.
2. The Agreement aims to limit the greenhouse gas emissions so that the rise in average global temperature by the end of this century does not exceed 2 °C or even 1.5 °C above pre-industrial levels.
3. Developed countries acknowledged their historical responsibility in global warming and committed to donate \$ 1000 billion a year from 2020 to help developing countries to cope with climate change.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 3 only
(b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2016

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q98. Consider the following statements :

1. The Sustainable Development Goals were first proposed in 1972 by a global think tank called the 'Club of Rome'.

2. The Sustainable Development Goals have to be achieved by 2030.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

— 2015 —

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q9. Which of the following National Parks is unique in being a swamp with floating vegetation that supports a rich biodiversity?

- (a) Bhitarkanika National Park
- (b) Keibul Lamjao National Park**
- (c) Keoladeo Ghana National Park
- (d) Sultanpur National Park

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

moderate

Q11. What can be the impact of excessive/inappropriate use of nitrogenous fertilizers in agriculture?

1. Proliferation of nitrogen-fixing microorganisms in soil can occur.

2. Increase in the acidity of soil can take place.

3. Leaching of nitrate to the ground-water can occur.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q12. With reference to the International Union for Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources (IUCN) and the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. IUCN is an organ of the United Nations and CITES is an international agreement between governments.
2. IUCN runs thousands of field projects around the world to better manage natural environments.
3. CITES is legally binding on the States that have joined it, but this Convention does not take the place of national laws.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

moderate

Q18. With reference to 'fly ash' produced by the power plants using coal as fuel, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Fly ash can be used in the production of bricks for building construction.
2. Fly ash can be used as a replacement for some of the Portland cement contents of concrete.
3. Fly ash is made up of silicon dioxide and calcium oxide only, and does not contain any toxic elements.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

moderate

Q19. With reference to 'dugong', a mammal found in India, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is a herbivorous marine animal.
2. It is found along the entire coast of India.
3. It is given legal protection under Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3**
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q25. Which one of the following is the national aquatic animal of India?

- (a) Saltwater crocodile
- (b) Olive ridley turtle
- (c) Gangetic dolphin**
- (d) Gharial

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q38. Which one of the following regions of India has a combination of mangrove forest, evergreen forest and deciduous forest?

- (a) North Coastal Andhra Pradesh
- (b) South-West Bengal
- (c) Southern Saurashtra
- (d) Andaman and Nicobar Islands**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q40. Which one of the following is associated with the issue of control and phasing out of the use of ozone-depleting substances?

- (a) Bretton Woods Conference
- (b) Montreal Protocol**
- (c) Kyoto Protocol
- (d) Nagoya Protocol

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q43. What is Rio+20 Conference, often mentioned in the news?

- (a) It is the United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development**
- (b) It is a Ministerial Meeting of the World Trade Organization
- (c) It is a Conference of the Inter-governmental Panel on Climate Change
- (d) It is a Conference of the Member Countries of the Convention on Biological Diversity

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q49. Which of the following statements regarding 'Green Climate Fund' is/are correct?

1. It is intended to assist the developing countries in adaptation and mitigation practices to counter climate change.

2. It is founded under the aegis of UNEP, OECD, Asian Development Bank and World Bank.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q52. Which one of the following National Parks has a climate that varies from tropical to subtropical, temperate and arctic?

(a) Khangchendzonga National Park

(b) Nandadevi National Park

(c) Neora Valley National Park

(d) Namdapha National Park

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q56. 'BioCarbon Fund Initiative for Sustainable Forest Landscapes' is managed by the

(a) Asian Development Bank

(b) International Monetary Fund

(c) United Nations Environment Programme

(d) World Bank

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q63. The Genetic Engineering Appraisal Committee is constituted under the

(a) Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006

(b) Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999

(c) Environment (Protection) Act, 1986

(d) Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972

Answer: (c)

Q69. In a particular region in India, the local people train the roots of living trees into robust bridges across the streams. As the time passes, these bridges become stronger. These unique 'living root bridges' are found in

- (a) Meghalaya**
- (b) Himachal Pradesh
- (c) Jharkhand
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (a)

Q74. With reference to 'Forest Carbon Partnership Facility', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is a global partnership of governments, businesses, civil society and indigenous peoples.
 2. It provides financial aid to universities, individual scientists and institutions involved in scientific forestry research to develop eco-friendly and climate adaptation technologies for sustainable forest management.
 3. It assists the countries in their 'REDD+ (Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation+)' efforts by providing them with financial and technical assistance.
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q76. With reference to an organization known as 'BirdLife International', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is a Global Partnership of Conservation Organizations.
 2. The concept of 'biodiversity hotspots' originated from this organization.
 3. It identifies the sites known/referred to as 'Important Bird and Biodiversity Areas'.
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q78. In India, in which one of the following types of forests is teak a dominant tree species?

- (a) Tropical moist deciduous forest**
- (b) Tropical rain forest
- (c) Tropical thorn scrub forest
- (d) Temperate forest with grasslands

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2015

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q84. Which one of the following is the best description of the term 'ecosystem'?

- (a) A community of organisms interacting with one another
- (b) That part of the Earth which is inhabited by living organisms
- (c) A community of organisms together with the environment in which they live**
- (d) The flora and fauna of a geographical area

Answer: (c)

— 2014 —

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

moderate

Q1. What are the significances of a practical approach to sugarcane production known as 'Sustainable Sugarcane Initiative'?

1. Seed cost is very low in this compared to the conventional method of cultivation.
2. Drip irrigation can be practiced very effectively in this.
3. There is no application of chemical/inorganic fertilizers at all in this.
4. The scope for intercropping is more in this compared to the conventional method of cultivation.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 1, 2 and 4 only**
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

Q2. If a wetland of international importance is brought under the 'Montreux Record', what does it imply?

(a) Changes in ecological character have occurred, are occurring or are likely to occur in the wetland as a result of human interference

(b) The country in which the wetland is located should enact a law to prohibit any human activity within five kilometres from the edge of the wetland

(c) The survival of the wetland depends on the cultural practices and traditions of certain communities living in its vicinity and therefore the cultural diversity therein should not be destroyed

(d) It is given the status of 'World Heritage Site'

Answer: (a)

Q5. With reference to Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS), consider the following statements :

1. It is an autonomous organization under the Ministry of Environment and Forests.

2. It strives to conserve nature through action-based research, education and public awareness.

3. It organizes and conducts nature trails and camps for the general public.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 3 only

(b) 2 only

(c) 2 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q6. With reference to 'Global Environment Facility', which of the following statements is/are correct?

(a) It serves as financial mechanism for 'Convention on Biological Diversity' and 'United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change'

(b) It undertakes scientific research on environmental issues at global level

(c) It is an agency under OECD to facilitate the transfer of technology and funds to underdeveloped countries with specific aim to protect their environment

(d) Both (a) and (b)

Answer: (a)

Q9. Consider the following pairs :

- 1. Dampa Tiger Reserve : Mizoram**
- 2. Gumti Wildlife Sanctuary : Sikkim**
- 3. Saramati Peak : Nagaland**

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q10. With reference to a conservation organization called 'Wetlands International', which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1. It is an intergovernmental organization formed by the countries which are signatories to Ramsar Convention.**
- 2. It works at the field level to develop and mobilize knowledge, and use the practical experience to advocate for better policies.**

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

Q14. Other than poaching, what are the possible reasons for the decline in the population of Ganges River Dolphins?

- 1. Construction of dams and barrages on rivers**
- 2. Increase in the population of crocodiles in rivers**
- 3. Getting trapped in fishing nets accidentally**
- 4. Use of synthetic fertilizers and other agricultural chemicals in crop-fields in the vicinity of rivers**

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only**
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

Q16. Brominated flame retardants are used in many household products like mattresses and upholstery. Why is there some concern about their use?

1. They are highly resistant to degradation in the environment.
2. They are able to accumulate in humans and animals.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2**
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

Q19. Which of the following adds/add carbon dioxide to the carbon cycle on the planet Earth?

1. Volcanic action
2. Respiration
3. Photosynthesis
4. Decay of organic matter

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 4 only**
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

Q20. If you walk through countryside, you are likely to see some birds stalking alongside the cattle to seize the insects disturbed by their movement through grasses. Which of the following is/are such bird/birds?

1. Painted Stork
2. Common Myna
3. Black-necked Crane

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

moderate

Q24. Which of the following are some important pollutants released by steel industry in India?

1. Oxides of sulphur
2. Oxides of nitrogen
3. Carbon monoxide
4. Carbon dioxide

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

moderate

Q26. Every year, a monthlong ecologically important campaign/festival is held during which certain communities/tribes plant saplings of fruit-bearing trees. Which of the following are such communities/tribes?

- (a) Bhutia and Lepcha
- (b) Gond and Korku**
- (c) Irula and Toda
- (d) Sahariya and Agariya

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q41. Which of the following have coral reefs?

1. Andaman and Nicobar Islands
2. Gulf of Kachchh
3. Gulf of Mannar
4. Sunderbans

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only**
- (b) 2 and 4 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q50. The most important strategy for the conservation of biodiversity together with traditional human life is the establishment of

- (a) biosphere reserves**
- (b) botanical gardens
- (c) national parks
- (d) wildlife sanctuaries

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q53. The scientific view is that the increase in global temperature should not exceed 2 °C above pre-industrial level. If the global temperature increases beyond 3 °C above the pre-industrial level, what can be its possible impact/impacts on the world?

1. Terrestrial biosphere tends toward a net carbon source.
2. Widespread coral mortality will occur.
3. All the global wetlands will permanently disappear.
4. Cultivation of cereals will not be possible anywhere in the world.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only**
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › Water & Wetland Conservation

moderate

Q56. What are the benefits of implementing the 'Integrated Watershed Development Programme'?

1. Prevention of soil runoff
2. Linking the country's perennial rivers with seasonal rivers
3. Rainwater harvesting and recharge of groundwater table
4. Regeneration of natural vegetation

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only**
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

moderate

Q64. With reference to Neem tree, consider the following statements :

1. Neem oil can be used as a pesticide to control the proliferation of some species of insects and mites.
2. Neem seeds are used in the manufacture of biofuels and hospital detergents.
3. Neem oil has applications in pharmaceutical industry.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q78. Consider the following international agreements :

1. The International Treaty on Plant Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture
2. The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification
3. The World Heritage Convention

Which of the above has/have a bearing on the biodiversity?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2014

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q79. Consider the following statements regarding 'Earth Hour' :

1. It is an initiative of UNEP and UNESCO.
2. It is a movement in which the participants switch off the lights for one hour on a certain day every year.
3. It is a movement to raise the awareness about the climate change and the need to save the planet.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q80. Which one of the following is the correct sequence of a food chain?

- (a) **Diatoms–Crustaceans–Herrings**
- (b) Crustaceans–Diatoms–Herrings
- (c) Diatoms–Herrings–Crustaceans
- (d) Crustaceans–Herrings–Diatoms

Answer: (a)

Q95. With reference to 'Eco-Sensitive Zones', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Eco-Sensitive Zones are the areas that are declared under the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.
2. The purpose of the declaration of Eco-Sensitive Zones is to prohibit all kinds of human activities in those zones except agriculture.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) **Neither 1 nor 2**

Answer: (d)

Q96. Consider the following statements :

1. Animal Welfare Board of India is established under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986.
2. National Tiger Conservation Authority is a statutory body.
3. National Ganga River Basin Authority is chaired by the Prime Minister.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) **2 and 3 only**
- (c) 2 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q7. Consider the following:

1. Star tortoise
2. Monitor lizard
3. Pygmy hog
4. Spider monkey

Which of the above are naturally found in India?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a)

Q8. Which of the following can be found as pollutants in the drinking water in some parts of India?

1. Arsenic
2. Sorbitol
3. Fluoride
4. Formaldehyde
5. Uranium

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 and 3 only
(b) 2, 4 and 5 only
(c) 1, 3 and 5 only
(d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Answer: (c)

Q10. Consider the following animals:

1. Sea cow
2. Sea horse
3. Sea lion

Which of the above is/are mammal/mammals?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only**
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q17. Consider the following pairs:

1. Nokrek Biosphere Reserve : Garo Hills
2. Loktak Lake : Barail Range
3. Namdapha National Park : Dafla Hills

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None

Answer: (a)

Q22. In the grasslands, trees do not replace the grasses as a part of an ecological succession because of

- (a) insects and fungi
- (b) limited sunlight and paucity of nutrients
- (c) water limits and fire**
- (d) None of the above

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2013

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q23. Which one of the following is the correct sequence of ecosystems in the order of decreasing productivity?

- (a) Oceans, lakes, grasslands, mangroves
- (b) Mangroves, oceans, grasslands, lakes
- (c) Mangroves, grasslands, lakes, oceans**
- (d) Oceans, mangroves, lakes, grasslands

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2013

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

moderate

Q29. Due to improper/indiscriminate disposal of old and used computers or their parts, which of the following are released into the environment as e-waste?

1. Beryllium
2. Cadmium
3. Chromium
4. Heptachlor
5. Mercury
6. Lead
7. Plutonium

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1, 3, 4, 6 and 7 only
- (b) 1, 2, 3, 5 and 6 only**
- (c) 2, 4, 5 and 7 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2013

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

easy

Q30. Acid rain is caused by the pollution of environment by

- (a) carbon dioxide and nitrogen
- (b) carbon monoxide and carbon dioxide
- (c) ozone and carbon dioxide
- (d) nitrous oxide and sulphur dioxide**

Answer: (d)

Q31. With reference to food chains in ecosystems, consider the following statements:

1. A food chain illustrates the order in which a chain of organisms feed upon each other.
2. Food chains are found within the populations of a species.
3. A food chain illustrates the numbers of each organism which are eaten by others.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None

Answer: (a)

Q32. Consider the following pairs: National Park : River flowing through the Park

1. Corbett National Park : Ganga
2. Kaziranga National Park : Manas
3. Silent Valley National Park : Kaveri

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) None

Answer: (d)

Q33. Consider the following organisms:

1. Agaricus
2. Nostoc
3. Spirogyra

Which of the above is/are used as biofertilizer/biofertilizers?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2013

Environment & Ecology › Biogeochemical Cycles & Earth Systems

moderate

Q34. Which of the following adds/add nitrogen to the soil?

1. Excretion of urea by animals
2. Burning of coal by man
3. Death of vegetation

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2013

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

moderate

Q35. In which of the following States is lion-tailed macaque found in its natural habitat?

1. Tamil Nadu
2. Kerala
3. Karnataka
4. Andhra Pradesh

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2013

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q48. Which one of the following terms describes not only the physical space occupied by an organism, but also its functional role in the community of organisms?

- (a) Ecotone
- (b) Ecological niche**
- (c) Habitat
- (d) Home range

Answer: (b)

Q49. Photochemical smog is a resultant of the reaction among

- (a) NO₂, O₃ and peroxyacetyl nitrate in the presence of sunlight**
- (b) CO, O₂ and peroxyacetyl nitrate in the presence of sunlight
- (c) CO, CO₂ and NO₂ at low temperature
- (d) high concentration of NO₂, O₃ and CO in the evening

Answer: (a)

Q53. With reference to the food chains in ecosystems, which of the following kinds of organism is/are known as decomposer organism/organisms?

- 1. Virus**
- 2. Fungi**
- 3. Bacteria**

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q55. Which of the following is/are unique characteristic/characteristics of equatorial forests?

- 1. Presence of tall, closely set trees with crowns forming a continuous canopy**
- 2. Coexistence of a large number of species**
- 3. Presence of numerous varieties of epiphytes**

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q87. Consider the following fauna of India:

1. Gharial
2. Leatherback turtle
3. Swamp deer

Which of the above is/are endangered?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3**
- (d) None

Answer: (c)

Q94. Which of the following leaf modifications occurs/occur in desert areas to inhibit water loss?

1. Hard and waxy leaves
2. Tiny leaves or no leaves
3. Thorns instead of leaves

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q97. Mycorrhizal biotechnology has been used in rehabilitating degraded sites because mycorrhiza enables the plants to

1. Resist drought and increase absorptive area
2. Tolerate extremes of pH
3. Resist disease infestation

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q3. How does National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) help in protecting the Indian agriculture?

1. NBA checks the biopiracy and protects the indigenous and traditional genetic resources.
2. NBA directly monitors and supervises the scientific research on genetic modification of crop plants.
3. Application for Intellectual Property Rights related to genetic/biological resources cannot be made without the approval of NBA.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q4. The National Green Tribunal Act, 2010 was enacted in consonance with which of the following provisions of the Constitution of India?

1. Right to healthy environment, construed as a part of Right to life under Article 21
2. Provision of grants for raising the level of administration in the Scheduled Areas for the welfare of Scheduled Tribes under Article 275(1)
3. Powers and functions of Gram Sabha as mentioned under Article 243(A)

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q5. If National Water Mission is properly and completely implemented, how will it impact the country?

1. Part of the water needs of urban areas will be met through recycling of waste-water.
2. The water requirements of coastal cities with inadequate alternative sources of water will be met by adopting appropriate technologies that allow for the use of ocean water.
3. All the rivers of Himalayan origin will be linked to the rivers of peninsular India.
4. The expenses incurred by farmers for digging bore-wells and for installing motors and pump-sets to draw groundwater will be completely reimbursed by the Government.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only**
- (c) 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

Q11. Consider the following kinds of organisms :

1. Bacteria
2. Fungi
3. Flowering plants

Some species of which of the above kinds of organisms are employed as biopesticides?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q12. Biomass gasification is considered to be one of the sustainable solutions to the power crisis in India. In this context, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Coconut shells, groundnut shells and rice husk can be used in biomass gasification.
2. The combustible gases generated from biomass gasification consist of hydrogen and carbon dioxide only.
3. The combustible gases generated from biomass gasification can be used for direct heat generation but not in internal combustion engines.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

Q15. Lead, ingested or inhaled, is a health hazard. After the addition of lead to petrol has been banned, what still are the sources of lead poisoning?

1. Smelting units
2. Pens and pencils
3. Paints
4. Hair oils and cosmetics

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only**
- (c) 2 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

Q17. Consider the following statements :

Chlorofluorocarbons, known as ozone-depleting substances, are used

- 1. in the production of plastic foams**
- 2. in the production of tubeless tyres**
- 3. in cleaning certain electronic components**
- 4. as pressurizing agents in aerosol cans**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 4 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only**
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

Q41. Government of India encourages the cultivation of 'sea buckthorn'. What is the importance of this plant?

- 1. It helps in controlling soil erosion and in preventing desertification.**
- 2. It is a rich source of biodiesel.**
- 3. It has nutritional value and is well-adapted to live in cold areas of high altitudes.**
- 4. Its timber is of great commercial value.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

Q46. With reference to the wetlands of India, consider the following statements :

- 1. The country's total geographical area under the category of wetlands is recorded more in Gujarat as compared to other States.**
- 2. In India, the total geographical area of coastal wetlands is larger than that of inland wetlands.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology > Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q50. The acidification of oceans is increasing. Why is this phenomenon a cause of concern?

1. The growth and survival of calcareous phytoplankton will be adversely affected.
2. The growth and survival of coral reefs will be adversely affected.
3. The survival of some animals that have phytoplanktonic larvae will be adversely affected.
4. The cloud seeding and formation of clouds will be adversely affected.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology > Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q62. The increasing amount of carbon dioxide in the air is slowly raising the temperature of the atmosphere, because it absorbs

- (a) the water vapour of the air and retains its heat
- (b) the ultraviolet part of the solar radiation
- (c) all the solar radiations
- (d) the infrared part of the solar radiation**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology > Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q87. Consider the following protected areas :

1. Bandipur
2. Bhitarkanika
3. Manas
4. Sunderbans

Which of the above are declared Tiger Reserves?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1, 3 and 4 only**
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology > Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q90. In which one among the following categories of protected areas in India are local people not allowed to collect and use the biomass?

- (a) Biosphere Reserves
- (b) National Parks**
- (c) Wetlands declared under Ramsar Convention
- (d) Wildlife Sanctuaries

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology > Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q91. Consider the following kinds of organisms :

- 1. Bat**
- 2. Bee**
- 3. Bird**

Which of the above is/are pollinating agent/agents?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology > Biodiversity & Conservation

moderate

Q92. Which one of the following groups of animals belongs to the category of endangered species?

- (a) Great Indian Bustard, Musk Deer, Red Panda and Asiatic Wild Ass**
- (b) Kashmir Stag, Cheetal, Blue Bull and Great Indian Bustard
- (c) Snow Leopard, Swamp Deer, Rhesus Monkey and Saras (Crane)
- (d) Lion-tailed Macaque, Blue Bull, Hanuman Langur and Cheetal

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2012

Environment & Ecology > Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q94. The Millennium Ecosystem Assessment describes the following major categories of ecosystem services—provisioning, supporting, regulating, preserving and cultural. Which one of the following is supporting service?

- (a) Production of food and water
- (b) Control of climate and disease
- (c) Nutrient cycling and crop pollination**
- (d) Maintenance of diversity

Answer: (c)

Q95. What is the difference between the antelopes Oryx and Chiru?

- (a) **Oryx is adapted to live in hot and arid areas whereas Chiru is adapted to live in steppes and semi-desert areas of cold high mountains**
(b) Oryx is poached for its antlers whereas Chiru is poached for its musk
(c) Oryx exists in western India only whereas Chiru exists in north-east India only
(d) None of the statements (a), (b) and (c) given above is correct

Answer: (a)

Q96. Which of the following can be threats to the biodiversity of a geographical area?

1. Global warming
2. Fragmentation of habitat
3. Invasion of alien species
4. Promotion of vegetarianism

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) **1, 2 and 3 only**
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a)

Q97. Consider the following :

1. Black-necked crane
2. Cheetah
3. Flying squirrel
4. Snow leopard

Which of the above are naturally found in India?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) **1, 3 and 4 only**
(c) 2 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

Q98. Consider the following agricultural practices :

1. Contour bunding
2. Relay cropping
3. Zero tillage

In the context of global climate change, which of the above helps/help in carbon sequestration/storage in the soil?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only**
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None of them

Answer: (b)

Q99. What would happen if phytoplankton of an ocean is completely destroyed for some reason?

1. The ocean as a carbon sink would be adversely affected.
2. The food chains in the ocean would be adversely affected.
3. The density of ocean water would drastically decrease.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

Q100. Vultures which used to be very common in Indian countryside some years ago are rarely seen nowadays. This is attributed to

- (a) the destruction of their nesting sites by new invasive species
- (b) a drug used by cattle owners for treating their diseased cattle**
- (c) scarcity of food available to them
- (d) a widespread, persistent and fatal disease among them

Answer: (b)

Q1. In the Union Budget 2011-12, a full exemption from the basic customs duty was extended to the bio-based asphalt (bioasphalt). What is the importance of this material?

1. Unlike traditional asphalt, bio-asphalt is not based on fossil fuels.
2. Bioasphalt can be made from non-renewable resources.
3. Bioasphalt can be made from organic waste materials.
4. It is eco-friendly to use bioasphalt for surfacing of the roads.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1, 3 and 4 only**
- (c) 2 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

Q2. Consider the following:

1. Carbon dioxide
2. Oxides of Nitrogen
3. Oxides of Sulphur

Which of the above is/are the emission/emissions from coal combustion at thermal power plants?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q9. The formation of ozone hole in the Antarctic region has been a cause of concern. What could be the reason for the formation of this hole?

- (a) Presence of prominent tropospheric turbulence; and inflow of chlorofluorocarbons
- (b) Presence of prominent polar front and stratospheric clouds; and inflow of chlorofluorocarbons**
- (c) Absence of polar front and stratospheric clouds; and inflow of methane and chlorofluorocarbons
- (d) Increased temperature at polar region due to global warming

Answer: (b)

Q12. Two important rivers – one with its source in Jharkhand (and known by a different name in Odisha), and another, with its source in Odisha – merge at a place only a short distance from the coast of Bay of Bengal before flowing into the sea. This is an important site of wildlife and biodiversity and a protected area.

Which one of the following could be this?

- (a) Bhitarkanika**
- (b) Chandipur-on-sea
- (c) Gopalpur-on-sea
- (d) Simlipal

Answer: (a)

Q15. Regarding “carbon credits”,

which one of the following statements is not correct?

- (a) The carbon credit system was ratified in conjunction with the Kyoto Protocol
- (b) Carbon credits are awarded to countries or groups that have reduced greenhouse gases below their emission quota
- (c) The goal of the carbon credit system is to limit the increase of carbon dioxide emission
- (d) Carbon credits are traded at a price fixed from time to time by the United Nations Environment Programme**

Answer: (d)

Q20. Three of the following criteria have contributed to the recognition of Western Ghats-Sri Lanka and Indo-Burma regions as hotspots of biodiversity:

1. Species richness

2. Vegetation density

3. Endemism

4. Ethno-botanical importance

5. Threat perception

6. Adaptation of flora and fauna to warm and humid conditions Which three of the above are correct criteria in this context?

- (a) 1, 2 and 6
- (b) 2, 4 and 6
- (c) 1, 3 and 5**
- (d) 3, 4 and 6

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2011

Environment & Ecology › Biogeochemical Cycles & Earth Systems

moderate

Q21. Human activities in the recent past have caused the increased concentration of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere, but a lot of it does not remain in the lower atmosphere because of

1. Its escape into the outer stratosphere,
2. The photosynthesis by phytoplankton in the oceans,
3. The trapping of air in the polar ice caps.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2011

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q22. In the context of ecosystem productivity, marine upwelling zones are important as they increase the marine productivity by bringing the

1. Decomposer microorganisms to the surface,
2. Nutrients to the surface,
3. Bottom-dwelling organisms to the surface.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2011

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q23. If a tropical rain forest is removed, it does not regenerate quickly as compared to a tropical deciduous forest. This is because

- (a) the soil of rain forest is deficient in nutrients**
- (b) propagules of the trees in a rain forest have poor viability
- (c) the rain forest species are slow-growing
- (d) exotic species invade the fertile soil of rain forest

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2011

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q24. The Himalayan Range is very rich in species diversity. Which one among the following is the most appropriate reason for this phenomenon?

- (a) It has a high rainfall that supports luxuriant vegetative growth
- (b) It is a confluence of different bio-geographical zones**
- (c) Exotic and invasive species have not been introduced in this region
- (d) It has less human interference

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2011

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q25. With reference to India, consider the following Central Acts:

1. Import and Export (Control) Act, 1947
2. Mining and Mineral Development (Regulation) Act, 1957
3. Customs Act, 1962
4. Indian Forest Act, 1927

Which of the above Acts have relevance to/bearing on the biodiversity conservation in the country?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 1, 2, 3 and 4**
- (d) None of the above Acts

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2011

Environment & Ecology › Water & Wetland Conservation

moderate

Q47. There is a concern over the increase in harmful algal blooms in the seawaters of India. What could be the causative factors for this phenomenon?

1. Discharge of nutrients from the estuaries.
2. Run-off from the land during the monsoon.
3. Upwelling in the seas.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

Q48. Consider the following :

1. Photosynthesis
2. Respiration
3. Decay of organic matter
4. Volcanic action

Which of the above add carbon dioxide to the carbon cycle on Earth ?

- (a) 1 and 4 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only**
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

Q51. A sandy and saline area is the natural habitat of an Indian animal species. The animal has no predators in that area but its existence is threatened due to the destruction of its habitat.

Which one of the following could be that animal ?

- (a) Indian wild buffalo
- (b) Indian wild ass**
- (c) Indian wild boar
- (d) Indian gazelle

Answer: (b)

Q61. Biodiversity forms the basis for human existence in the following ways:

1. Soil formation
2. Prevention of soil erosion
3. Recycling of waste
4. Pollination of crops

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 1 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Answer: (d)

Q72. Which one of the following is not a site for in-situ method of conservation of flora?

- (a) Biosphere Reserve
- (b) Botanical Garden**
- (c) National Park
- (d) Wildlife Sanctuary

Answer: (b)

Q76. The 2004 Tsunami made people realize that mangroves can serve as a reliable safety hedge against coastal calamities. How do mangroves function as a safety hedge?

- (a) The mangrove swamps separate the human settlements from the sea by a wide zone in which people neither live nor venture out
- (b) The mangroves provide both food and medicines which people are in need of after any natural disaster
- (c) The mangrove trees are tall with dense canopies and serve as an excellent shelter during a cyclone or tsunami
- (d) The mangrove trees do not get uprooted by storms and tides because of their extensive roots**

Answer: (d)

Q79. The "Red Data Books" published by the International Union for Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources (IUCN) contain lists of

- 1. Endemic plant and animal species present in the biodiversity hotspots.**
- 2. Threatened plant and animal species.**
- 3. Protected sites for conservation of nature and natural resources in various countries.**

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 and 3
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

Q96. Consider the following statements:

1. Biodiversity is normally greater in the lower latitudes as compared to the higher latitudes.
2. Along the mountain gradients, biodiversity is normally greater in the lower altitudes as compared to the higher altitudes.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2**
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

— 2010 —

Q4. A new type of El Nino called El Nino Modoki appeared in the news. In this context, consider the following statements:

1. Normal El Nino forms in the Central Pacific ocean whereas El Nino Modoki forms in Eastern Pacific ocean.
2. Normal El Nino results in diminished hurricanes in the Atlantic ocean but El Nino Modoki results in a greater number of hurricanes with greater frequency.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

Q20. Consider the following statements :

1. Biodiversity hotspots are located only in tropical regions.
2. India has four biodiversity hotspots i.e., Eastern Himalayas, Western Himalayas, Western Ghats and Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2**

Answer: (d)

Q22. Consider the following statements:

1. The boundaries of a National Park are defined by legislation.
2. A Biosphere Reserve is declared to conserve a few specific species of flora and fauna.
3. In a Wildlife Sanctuary, limited biotic interference is permitted.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q23. A pesticide which is a chlorinated hydrocarbon is sprayed on a food crop. The food chain is: Food crop – Rat – Snake – Hawk. In this food chain, the highest concentration of the pesticide would accumulate

in which one of the following?

- (a) Food crop
- (b) Rat
- (c) Snake
- (d) Hawk**

Answer: (d)

Q38. Consider the following:

1. Oxides of Hydrogen
2. Oxides of Nitrogen
3. Oxides of Sulphur

Which of the above causes/cause acid rain?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Q56. The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) is an international treaty drawn at

- (a) United Nations' Conference on the Human Environment, Stockholm, 1972
- (b) UN Conference on Environment and Development, Rio de Janeiro, 1992**
- (c) World Summit on Sustainable Development, Johannesburg, 2002
- (d) UN Climate Change Conference, Copenhagen, 2009

Answer: (b)

Q59. India is a party to the Ramsar Convention and has declared many areas as Ramsar Sites.

Which of the following statements best describes how we should maintain these sites in the context of this Convention?

- (a) Keep all the sites completely inaccessible to man so that they will not be exploited.
- (b) Conserve all the sites through ecosystem approach and permit tourism and recreation only.
- (c) Conserve all the sites through ecosystem approach for a period without any exploitation, with specific criteria and specific period for each site, and then allow sustainable use of them by future generations.
- (d) Conserve all the sites through ecosystem approach and allow their simultaneous sustainable use.**

Answer: (d)

Q60. Other than *Jatropha curcas*, why is *Pongamia pinnata* also considered a good option for the production of bio-diesel in India?

- 1. *Pongamia pinnata* grows naturally in most of the arid regions of India.**
- 2. The seeds of *Pongamia pinnata* are rich in lipid content of which nearly half is oleic acid.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2**
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2010

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q61. Due to their extensive rice cultivation, some regions may be contributing to global warming. To what possible reason/reasons is this attributable?

1. The anaerobic conditions associated with rice cultivation cause the emission of methane.
2. When nitrogen based fertilizers are used, nitrous oxide is emitted from the cultivated soil.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2010

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q62. Sustainable development is described as the development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs. In this perspective, inherently the concept of sustainable development is intertwined with

which of the following concepts ?

- (a) Social justice and empowerment
- (b) Inclusive Growth
- (c) Globalization
- (d) Carrying capacity

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2010

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

easy

Q63. Given below are the names of four energy crops. Which one of them can be cultivated for ethanol ?

- (a) Jatropha
- (b) Maize
- (c) Pongamia
- (d) Sunflower

Answer: (b)

Q64. Consider the following pairs:

Protected area — Well-known for

1. Bhitarkanika, Orissa — Salt Water Crocodile
2. Desert National Park, Rajasthan — Great Indian Bustard
3. Eravikulam, Kerala — Hoolak Gibbon

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only**
- (c) 2 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q65. Some species of plants are insectivorous. Why ?

- (a) Their growth in shady and dark places does not allow them to undertake sufficient photosynthesis and thus they depend on insects for nutrition.
- (b) They are adapted to grow in nitrogen deficient soils and thus depend on insects for sufficient nitrogenous nutrition.**
- (c) They cannot synthesize certain vitamins themselves and depend on the insects digested by them.
- (d) They have remained in that particular stage of evolution as living fossils, a link between autotrophs and heterotrophs.

Answer: (b)

Q69. In India, which type of forest among the following occupies the largest area?

- (a) Montane Wet Temperate Forest
- (b) Sub-tropical Dry Evergreen Forest
- (c) Tropical Moist Deciduous Forest**
- (d) Tropical Wet Evergreen Forest

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2010

Environment & Ecology › Biogeochemical Cycles & Earth Systems

easy

Q74. Which one of the following reflects back more sunlight as compared to the other three?

- (a) Sand desert
- (b) Paddy crop land
- (c) Land covered with fresh snow**
- (d) Prairie land

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2010

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q103. King Cobra is the only snake that makes its own nest. Why does it make its nest?

- (a) It is a snake-eater and the nest helps attract other snakes
- (b) It is a viviparous snake and needs a nest to give birth to its offspring
- (c) It is an oviparous snake and lays its eggs in the nest and guards the nest until they are hatched**
- (d) It is a large, cold blooded animal, and needs a nest to hibernate in the cold season

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2010

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q104. As a result of their annual survey, the National Geographic Society and an international polling firm GlobeScan gave India top rank in Greendex 2009 score. What is this score?

- (a) It is a measure of efforts made by different countries in adopting technologies for reducing carbon footprint
- (b) It is a measure of environmentally sustainable consumer behaviour in different countries**
- (c) It is an assessment of programmes/schemes undertaken by different countries for improving the conservation of natural resources
- (d) It is an index showing the volume of carbon credits sold by different countries

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2010

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

moderate

Q105. Consider the following statements:

- 1. The Taxus tree naturally found in the Himalayas.**
- 2. The Taxus tree is listed in the Red Data Book.**
- 3. A drug called "taxol" is obtained from Taxus tree is effective against Parkinson's disease.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only**
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Q129. What are the possible limitations of India in mitigating the global warming at present and in the immediate future ?

1. Appropriate alternate technologies are not sufficiently available.
2. India cannot invest huge funds in research and development.
3. Many developed countries have already set up their polluting industries in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

Q149. Consider the following which can be found in the ambient atmosphere :

1. Soot
2. Sulphur hexafluoride
3. Water vapour

Which of the above contribute to the warming up of the atmosphere ?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

— 2009 —

Q4. In India,

which one of the following States has the largest inland saline wetland?

- (a) Gujarat
- (b) Haryana
- (c) Madhya Pradesh
- (d) Rajasthan

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2009

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q90. Which one of the following Union Ministries implements the Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety ?

- (a) Ministry of Science and Technology
- (b) Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- (c) Ministry of Environment and Forests**
- (d) Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2009

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

easy

Q91. Where is the headquarters of Animal Welfare Board of India located ?

- (a) Ahmedabad
- (b) Chennai**
- (c) Hyderabad
- (d) Kolkata

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2009

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

easy

Q111. In the context of CO₂ emission and Global Warming, what is the name of a market-driven device under the UNFCCC that allows developing countries to get funds/incentives from the developed countries to adopt better technologies that reduce greenhouse gas emissions ?

- (a) Carbon Footprint
- (b) Carbon Credit Rating
- (c) Clean Development Mechanism**
- (d) Emission Reduction Norm

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2009

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

easy

Q112. The concept of carbon credit originated

from which one of the following ?

- (a) Earth Summit, Rio de Janeiro
- (b) Kyoto Protocol**
- (c) Montreal Protocol
- (d) G-8 Summit, Heiligendamm

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2009

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q132. The marine animal called dugong which is vulnerable to extinction is a/an

- (a) Amphibian
- (b) Bony fish
- (c) Shark
- (d) Mammal**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2009

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

moderate

Q142. Consider the following names :

- 1. Ike**
- 2. Kate**
- 3. Gustav**

Which of the above are the names of hurricanes that had occurred very recently ?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2009

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

easy

Q143. In the context of alternative sources of energy, ethanol as a viable bio-fuel can be obtained from

- (a) Potato
- (b) Rice
- (c) Sugarcane**
- (d) Wheat

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2009

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

moderate

Q148. Consider the following regions:

1. Eastern Himalayas
2. Eastern Mediterranean region
3. North-western Australia

Which of the above is/are Biodiversity Hotspot(s)?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only**
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2009

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q150. The Panda belongs to the same family as that of

- (a) Bear**
- (b) Cat
- (c) Dog
- (d) Rabbit

Answer: (a)

— 2008 —

UPSC 2008

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

easy

Q13. Which one of the following Union Ministries is implementing the Biodiesel Mission (as Nodal Ministry)?

- (a) Ministry of Agriculture
- (b) Ministry of Science and Technology
- (c) Ministry of New and Renewable Energy
- (d) Ministry of Rural Development**

Answer: (d)

Q20. Consider the following:

1. Rice fields
2. Coal mining
3. Domestic animals
4. Wetlands

Which of the above are sources of methane, a major greenhouse gas?

- (a) 1 and 4 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Answer: (d)

Q25. Consider the following statements:

1. Salt-water crocodile is found in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.
2. Shrew and tapir are found in the Western Ghats of the Malabar region.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

Q29. For which one of the following snakes is the diet mainly composed of other snakes?

- (a) Krait
- (b) Russell's viper
- (c) Rattlesnake
- (d) King cobra**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2008

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q90. Out of all the Biosphere Reserves in India, four have been recognized on the World Network by UNESCO.

Which one of the following is not one of them?

- (a) Gulf of Mannar
- (b) Kanchenjunga**
- (c) Nanda Devi
- (d) Sunderbans

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2008

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q95. Where was the World Summit on Sustainable Development (Rio + 10) held?

- (a) Davos
- (b) Nova Scotia
- (c) Johannesburg**
- (d) Shanghai

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2008

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q96. Consider the following statements:

1. Clean Development Mechanism (CDM) in respect of carbon credits is one of the Kyoto Protocol Mechanisms.

2. Under the CDM, the projects handled pertain only to the Annex-I countries.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2008

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

easy

Q137. The release

of which one of the following into ponds and wells helps in controlling the mosquitoes?

- (a) Crab
- (b) Dogfish
- (c) Gambusia fish**
- (d) Snail

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2008

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q145. Which one among the following has the maximum number of National Parks?

- (a) Andaman and Nicobar Islands**
- (b) Arunachal Pradesh
- (c) Assam
- (d) Meghalaya

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2008

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q146. Among the following, which one is not an ape?

- (a) Gibbon
- (b) Gorilla
- (c) Langur**
- (d) Orangutan

Answer: (c)

— 2007 —

UPSC 2007

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

easy

Q6. Wangari Maathai, the Nobel Prize winner from Kenya, is known for her contribution

to which one of the following?

- (a) Journalism
- (b) International economics
- (c) Sustainable development**
- (d) Child development

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2007

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q70. Which one of the following is also known as Top Slip?

- (a) Simlipal National Park
- (b) Periyar Wildlife Sanctuary
- (c) Manjira Wildlife Sanctuary
- (d) Indira Gandhi Wildlife Sanctuary and National Park**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2007

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q87. Which of the following is located in the Bastar region?

- (a) Bandhavgarh National Park
- (b) Dandeli Sanctuary
- (c) Rajaji National Park
- (d) Indravati National Park**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2007

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q90. The largest coral reef in the world is found near the coast

of which one of the following countries?

- (a) Australia**
- (b) Cuba
- (c) Ghana
- (d) Philippines

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2007

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

easy

Q93. Dalbergia species is associated with

which one of the following?

- (a) Cashew-nut
- (b) Coffee
- (c) Tea
- (d) Rosewood**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2007

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q94. Consider the following statements :

1. In India, Red Panda is naturally found in the western Himalaya only.

2. In India, Slow Loris lives in the dense forests of the North-East.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

— 2006 —

UPSC 2006

Environment & Ecology › Climate Change & Greenhouse Gases

moderate

Q54. Which one of the following countries is the first country in the world to propose a carbon tax for its people to address global warming?

- (a) Australia
- (b) Germany
- (c) Japan
- (d) New Zealand**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2006

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q71. Where is Bundala Biosphere Reserve which has been recently added to the UNESCO's Man and Biosphere (MAB) network, located?

- (a) Russia
- (b) India
- (c) Sri Lanka**
- (d) Bangladesh

Answer: (c)

— 2005 —

Q6. Consider the following statements :

1. Kyoto Protocol came into force in the year 2005
2. Kyoto Protocol deals primarily with the depletion of the Ozone layer.
3. Methane as a greenhouse gas is more harmful than carbon dioxide

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 1 and 3**
- (c) 1 only
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

Q12. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List I (National Park/Wild-life Sanctuary)

- (A) Bondla Wildlife Sanctuary**
- (B) Kangerghat National Park**
- (C) Orang Sanctuary**
- (D) Ushakothi Wildlife Sanctuary**

List II (State)

1. Orissa
2. Assam
3. Chhattisgarh
4. Goa
5. Tripura

- (a) A-2 B-4 C-5 D-1
- (b) A-4 B-3 C-2 D-1**
- (c) A-2 B-3 C-5 D-4
- (d) A-4 B-1 C-2 D-3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2005

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

easy

Q82. Which one of the following is not a Biosphere Reserve?

- (a) Agasthyamalai
- (b) Nallamalai**
- (c) Nilgiri
- (d) Panchmarhi

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2005

Environment & Ecology › Water & Wetland Conservation

easy

Q115. Virtual water trade is being looked at by experts as a solution to the world's water crisis. What does virtual water (VW) imply?

- (a) Volume of heavy water required to replace ordinary water.
- (b) Volume of water required to produce a commodity or service.**
- (c) Volume of water saved by using rainwater harvesting.
- (d) Volume of water utilized by an effective flood control.

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2005

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q134. Consider the following statements:

- 1. Silent Valley National Park is in the Nallamalai range.**
- 2. Pathrakkadavu Hydroelectric Project is proposed to be built near the Silent Valley National Park.**
- 3. The Kunthi river originates in Silent Valley's rainforests.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3**
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2005

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

moderate

Q138. Which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) The First Meeting of the Parties (MOP-1) to the Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety was held in the Philippines in 2004.
- (b) India is not a signatory to the Biosafety Protocol/Convention on Biological Diversity.
- (c) The Biosafety Protocol deals with genetically modified organisms.**
- (d) The United States of America is a member of the Biosafety Protocol/Convention on Biological Diversity.

Answer: (c)

Q147. Consider the following statements:

1. The forest cover in India constitutes around 20 % of its geographical area. Out of the total forest cover, dense forest constitutes around 40 %.

2. The National Forestry Action Programme aims at bringing one-third of the area of India under tree/forest cover.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

— 2004 —

Q12. Consider the following statements:

1. Toothless mammals such as pangolins are not found in India.

2. Gibbon is the only ape found in India.

Which of these statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

Q46. Tarun Bharat Sangh, an organization based in a village near Alwar (Rajasthan) has become famous because of

- (a) Cultivation of genetically modified cotton
- (b) Rehabilitation of women victims of AIDS
- (c) Livelihood projects for destitute rural women
- (d) Rain-water harvesting**

Answer: (d)

Q65. Match List I (National Park/Sanctuary) with List II (State) and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

List I

(A) Kanger Ghati National Park

(B) Nagerhole National Park

(C) Kugti Wildlife Sanctuary

(D) Sultanpur Bird Sanctuary

List II

1. Chhattisgarh

2. Haryana

3. Himachal Pradesh

4. Karnataka

Codes:

A B C D

(a) 3 2 1 4

(b) 1 4 3 2

(c) 3 4 1 2

(d) 1 2 3 4

Answer: (b)

Q107. Match List I (Biosphere Reserve) with List II (States) and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

List I

- (A) Simlipal
- (B) Dehong Deband
- (C) Nokrek
- (D) Kanchenjunga

List II

- 1. Sikkim
- 2. Uttaranchal
- 3. Arunachal Pradesh
- 4. Orissa
- 5. Meghalaya

Codes:

- (a) A 1 B 3 C 5 D 4
- (b) A 4 B 5 C 2 D 1
- (c) A 1 B 5 C 2 D 4
- (d) A 4 B 3 C 5 D 1**

Answer: (d)

Q135. Amongst the following Indian States which one has the minimum total forest cover?

- (a) Sikkim
- (b) Goa
- (c) Haryana**
- (d) Kerala

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2003

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

easy

Q19. The Genetic Engineering Approval Committee, whose permission is required for cultivation of any genetically modified crop such as Bt-Cotton in India, is under the Union Minister of

- (a) Agriculture
- (b) Environment and Forests**
- (c) Commerce and Industry
- (d) Rural Development

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2003

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

moderate

Q67. Consider the following animals of India:

- 1. Crocodile**
- 2. Elephant**

Which of these is/are endangered species?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2**
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2003

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

moderate

Q99. Consider the following statements:

- 1. The common blue green algae Spirogyra and Ulothrix are found in both fresh water ponds and oceans.**
- 2. The chameleon can look ahead with one eye, and at the same time look behind with another.**

Which of these statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2**
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

Q106. Assertion (A): Coal-based thermal power stations contribute to acid rain.

Reason (R): Oxides of carbon are emitted when the coal burns.

- (a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A**
- (c) A is true but R is false
- (d) A is false but R is true

Answer: (b)

Q110. Assertion (A): Unlike temperate forests, the tropical rain forests, if cleared, can yield productive farm-land that can support intensive agriculture for several years even without chemical fertilizers.

Reason (R): The primary productivity of the tropical rain forest is very high when compared to that of the temperate forests.

- (a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true but R is false
- (d) A is false but R is true**

Answer: (d)

Q118. Which one of following is produced during the formation of photochemical smog?

- (a) Hydrocarbons
- (b) Nitrogen Oxides
- (c) Ozone**
- (d) Methane

Answer: (c)

— 2002 —

Q74. Which one of the following animals is monogamous?

- (a) Wolf**
- (b) Walrus
- (c) Seal
- (d) Deer

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2002

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q126. A World Summit with representation from all the countries will be held in Johannesburg in September 2002 on the subject of

- (a) AIDS control
- (b) Global terrorism
- (c) Human rights
- (d) Sustainable development**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2002

Environment & Ecology › Biogeochemical Cycles & Earth Systems

moderate

Q136. Consider the following ecosystems:

1. Taiga
2. Tropical evergreen
3. Tropical deciduous
4. Tundra

The correct sequence in decreasing order of the albedo values of these ecosystems is

- (a) 1, 4, 3, 2
- (b) 4, 1, 2, 3
- (c) 4, 1, 3, 2**
- (d) 1, 4, 2, 3

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2002

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity

easy

Q138. The sea coast

of which one of the following states has become famous as a nesting place for the giant Olive Ridley turtles from South America?

- (a) Goa
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Orissa**
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (c)

Q35. Consider the following statements regarding environment issues of India:

I. Gulf of Mannar is one of the biosphere reserves.

II. The Ganga Action Plan, phase II has been merged with the National River Conservation Plan.

III. The National Museum of Natural History at New Delhi imparts nonformal education in environment and conservation.

IV. Environmental Information System (ENVIS) acts as a decentralised information network for environmental information.

Which of these statements are correct?

- (a) I, II and IV
- (b) I, II, III and IV**
- (c) II and III
- (d) I, III and IV

Answer: (b)

Q52. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I (Important Day)

I. World Environment Day

II. World Forestry Day

III. World Habitat Day

IV. World Ozone Day

List II (Date)

A) March 20

B) June 5

C) September 16

D) October 3

E) December 10

- (a) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-E
- (b) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (c) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (d) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C**

Answer: (d)

Q96. A class of animals known as Marsupials is a characteristic feature of

- (a) Africa
- (b) Australia**
- (c) South America
- (d) South-east Asia

Answer: (b)

— 2000 —

Q35. Match List I (Power generation plant) with List II (Feed material)

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I

I. M/s Gowthami Solvents Oil Limited, Andhra Pradesh

II. M/s KM. Sugar Mills, Uttar Pradesh

III. M/s Satia Paper Mills, Punjab

IV. M/s Al Kabeer Exports Limited, Andhra Pradesh

List II

A) Rice husk

B) Slaughter-house waste

C) Distillery spent wash

D) Black liquor

Codes:

- (a) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (b) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (c) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B**
- (d) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2000

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q126. Within biological communities, some species are important in determining the ability of a large number of other species to persist in the community. Such species are called

- (a) Keystone species**
- (b) Allopatric species
- (c) Sympatric species
- (d) Threatened species

Answer: (a)

— 1999 —

UPSC 1999

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

easy

Q36. The minimum land area recommended for forest cover to maintain proper ecological balance in India is

- (a) 25%
- (b) 33%**
- (c) 43%
- (d) 53%

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1999

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q54. "India has the largest population of the Asian

X. Today, there are just about 20,000 to 25,000 X in their natural habitat spreading across the evergreen forests, dry thorn forests, swamps and grasslands. Their prime habitats are, however, the moist deciduous forests. The X population in India ranges from Northwest India where they are found in the forest divisions of Dehradun, Bijnor and Nainital districts of UP to the Western Ghats in the states of Karnataka and Kerala and in Tamil Nadu. In Central India, their population is distributed in southern Bihar and Orissa. In the East, they are seen in North Bengal, Assam and a few other states." The animal 'X' referred to in this quotation is

- (a) Lion
- (b) Elephant**
- (c) Tiger
- (d) One horned rhinoceros

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1999

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q73. The first marine sanctuary in India, having within its bounds coral reefs, Mollusca, dolphins, tortoises and various kinds of sea birds, has been established in

- (a) Sundarbans
- (b) Chilka Lake
- (c) Gulf of Kachchh**
- (d) Lakshadweep

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1999

Environment & Ecology › Environmental Governance & Legislation

moderate

Q77. Which one of the following legislations does not deal with the protection of environment?

- (a) The Water (Cess) Act, 1977
- (b) The Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980
- (c) The Public Liability Insurance Act, 1991
- (d) The Port Laws Amendment Act, 1997**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1999

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

easy

Q121. Which one of the following agricultural practices is eco-friendly?

- (a) Organic farming**
- (b) Shifting cultivation
- (c) Cultivation of high yielding varieties
- (d) Growing plants in glass-houses

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1999

Environment & Ecology › Ecosystems & Ecology Concepts

easy

Q123. Which one of the following is a useful functional association between fungi and the roots of higher plants?

- (a) Biofertilizer
- (b) Coralloid root
- (c) Lichen
- (d) Mycorrhiza**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1998

Environment & Ecology › Sustainable Agriculture & Forestry

easy

Q22. Indonesian forest fire in 1997 was caused by

- (a) greenhouse effect
- (b) depletion of the ozone layer
- (c) El Niño effects
- (d) None of the above**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1998

Environment & Ecology › International Environmental Treaties & Summits

easy

Q42. According to Meadows (1972), if the present trends in world population, industrialisation, pollution, food production and resource depletion continue unchanged, the "Limits to Growth" on our planet will be reached in the next

- (a) 50 years
- (b) 100 years**
- (c) 150 years
- (d) 200 years

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1998

Environment & Ecology › Water & Wetland Conservation

easy

Q54. Estuaries possess distinct blooms of excessive growth of a pigmented dinoflagellate. These blooms are called

- (a) red tides**
- (b) sea tides
- (c) black tides
- (d) sea flowers

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1998

Environment & Ecology › Water & Wetland Conservation

easy

Q65. Some people in Manipur live in houses built on floating islands of weeds and decaying vegetation held together by suspended silt. These islands are called

- (a) Tipis
- (b) Barkhans
- (c) Phumdis**
- (d) Izba

Answer: (c)

Q72. Forest areas have been labelled as 1, 2, 3 and 4 in the rough outline map given. Among these, those which were threatened in 1997 by a serious epidemic include



- (a) Teak forests of 3 and 4
- (b) Oak forests of 1 and sal forests of 2
- (c) Sal forests of 3**
- (d) Sandalwood forests of 4

Answer: (c)

Q92. 'Eco mark' is given to the Indian products that are

- (a) pure and unadulterated
- (b) rich in proteins
- (c) environment friendly**
- (d) economically viable

Answer: (c)

Q101. World Environment Conference to discuss global warming was held in 1997 in

- (a) Stockholm
- (b) Rio de Janeiro
- (c) Paris
- (d) Kyoto**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1998

Environment & Ecology › Water & Wetland Conservation

easy

Q102. The water pollution in river is measured by the dissolved amount of

- (a) Chlorine
- (b) Ozone
- (c) Nitrogen
- (d) Oxygen**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1998

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q120. A tree species in Mauritius failed to reproduce because of the extinction of a fruit-eating bird.

Which one of the following was that bird?

- (a) Dove
- (b) Dodo**
- (c) Condor
- (d) Skua

Answer: (b)

— 1997 —

UPSC 1997

Environment & Ecology › Pollution & Waste Management

moderate

Q120. Which one of the following organisms is likely to show the highest concentration of DDT once it has been introduced into the ecosystem?

- (a) Grasshopper
- (b) Toad
- (c) Snake**
- (d) Cattle

Answer: (c)

— 1996 —

UPSC 1996

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q39. Which one of the following regions of India is now regarded as an 'ecological hot spot'?

- (a) Western Himalayas
- (b) Eastern Himalayas
- (c) Western Ghats**
- (d) Eastern Ghats

Answer: (c)

Q49. Assertion (A): Mangroves are very specialised forest ecosystems of tropical and subtropical regions bordering certain sea coasts.

Reason (R): They stabilise the shoreline and act as bulwark against encroachments by sea.

In the context of the above two statements,

which one of the following is correct?

- (a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A**
- (b) Both A and R are true but R is not a correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true but R is false
- (d) A is false but R is true

Answer: (a)

Q63. Consider the following programmes:

I. Afforestation and development of wastelands.

II. Reforestation and replantation in existing forests.

III. Encouraging the wood substitutes and supplying other types of fuel.

IV. Promotion of wide use of insecticides and pesticides to restrict the loss of forest area from degradation caused by pests and insects.

The National Forest Policy of 1988 includes

- (a) I, II, III and IV
- (b) II and IV
- (c) I, III and IV
- (d) I, II and III**

Answer: (d)

Q106. Physico-chemical characteristics of water in water sources undergo changes due to

- (a) aquatic macrophytes
- (b) aquatic fungi
- (c) effluents**
- (d) evapotranspiration

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1996

Environment & Ecology › Biodiversity & Conservation

easy

Q107. Ecologists have so far found and certified a large number of species in the plant and animal kingdoms. In terms of members, the largest group identified so far is among the

- (a) Fungi
- (b) Plants
- (c) Insects**
- (d) Bacteria

Answer: (c)

— 1995 —

UPSC 1995

Environment & Ecology › Water & Wetland Conservation

moderate

Q32. "Monoculture of commercially viable trees is destroying the unique natural profile of Thoughtless exploitation of timber, deforesting vast tracts for palm cultivation, destruction of mangroves, illegal logging by tribals and poaching only compound the problem. Fresh water pockets are fast drying up due to deforestation and destruction of mangroves." The place referred to in this quotation is

- (a) Sundarbans**
- (b) Kerala Coast
- (c) Orissa Coast
- (d) Andaman and Nicobar Islands

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1995

Environment & Ecology › Protected Areas & Wildlife

moderate

Q69. Which one of the following does not belong to biosphere reserves set up so far?

- (a) Great Nicobar
- (b) Sunderbans
- (c) Nanda Devi
- (d) Gulf of Kachchh**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1995

Environment & Ecology › Renewable Energy & Green Technologies

easy

Q117. Which one of the following fuels causes minimum environmental pollution?

- (a) Diesel
- (b) Coal
- (c) Hydrogen**
- (d) Kerosene

Answer: (c)

Q128. "The final Agent Orange raid in Vietnam took place in 1970.... areas have begun to bloom again. But 19 years after the war's end, it seems plain that Agent Orange is killing and maiming human beings, something it never intended to do. The apparent toxic fall-out from those clouds ... is a crop of human miseries including cancers, miscarriages and birth defects — that may persist for decades." The offensive substance referred to in the above quotation is

- (a) DDT used as insecticide
- (b) a complex mixture of herbicides and weedicides used to increase agricultural output in the then South Vietnam under the US aid programme
- (c) a complex mixture of DDT and other insecticides used as aerial sprays for protection against malaria and other tropical diseases
- (d) dioxin used as defoliants**

Answer: (d)

Q145. Consider the table given below providing details of traffic volume per hour for four locations (showing total traffic volume, % of heavy vehicles, average noise level in dB(A) and noise-pollution level in dB(A)). When the total traffic volume is the same, the factor(s) which affect(s) the noise-pollution level is/are

- (a) % of heavy vehicles**
- (b) noise-pollution level and average noise level
- (c) average noise level and % of heavy vehicles
- (d) indeterminable on the basis of details given

Answer: (a)